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# THE POLITIC

YALE'S JOURNAL OF POLITICS

## AMERICA'S BOUNDARIES:
## A Nation Transformed

**Featuring:**

Gary Hart

Jim Ryun

Todd Tiahrt

Strobe Talbott

H.I.M. Reza Pahlavi

$5.95

Volume 1, Issue 2

November 16, 2001

# THE POLITIC

## Yale's Journal of Politics

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## APOLOGIES

The staff of *The Politic* would like to apologize for a number of errors that appeared in our inaugural issue. The picture of Professor James Tobin that appeared on page 14 was incorrectly labeled. This is not a picture of Professor Tobin, and we have asked the website from which we downloaded the picture to remove it. In addition, we wish to apologize to the Yale University Office of Development for the error that occured in its advertisement during publication. Lastly, in light of the recent tragic events in Washington, D.C. several contributors, including Congressman J.C. Watts and Senator Barbara Mikulski were unable to contribute to this issue, but will likely be a part of our spring issue. Thank you for your understanding, and we hope that you will continue to enjoy future editions of *The Politic*.

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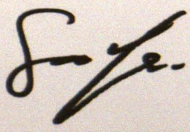
Dear Reader,

We founded *The Politic* almost a year ago in the hopes of providing a venue to connect the leaders of today's government with the student leaders of tomorrow. By creating this non-partisan forum, students can learn from the experiences and historical perspectives of current governments. The lessons of history cannot be forgotten. In order to transcend stereotypes and avoid unnecessary conflict, we must attain a better understanding of the political, economic, and social pedagogies of our changing world.

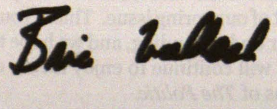
In the wake of September 11th, the importance and relevance of this goal has become glaringly obvious. This issue does not simply retell the events of 9/11, but instead explores responses to the current crisis. Additionally, the magazine makes full use of personal narratives, contentious opinions, and relevant artwork in establishing a constructive dialogue aimed toward explanations and solutions of today's crisis.

There are, however, certain events in the course of history that seem to defy easy explanation. Over the past few weeks, we have watched the world shift from a period of mourning to that of reflection. While extending our deepest sympathies and condolences to those who have been affected, directly and indirectly, by these events, *The Politic* opens the forum of debate. In this debate, one axiom is clear: the principles that have governed our nation and world in the past few decades have irrevocably changed. The world order of the 21st century is in a state of flux. With the razing of the World Trade Center towers came the challenge of our generation. The challenges of the previous generations – World War I, World War II, Vietnam, and the Cold War – are comparable in scope to the task of combating terrorism and encouraging globalization in the face of biological, chemical, and nuclear warfare. We must not act out of vengeance, but use the lessons of history to help formulate viable solutions.

Sincerely,



Sam Yebri



Brian Wallach

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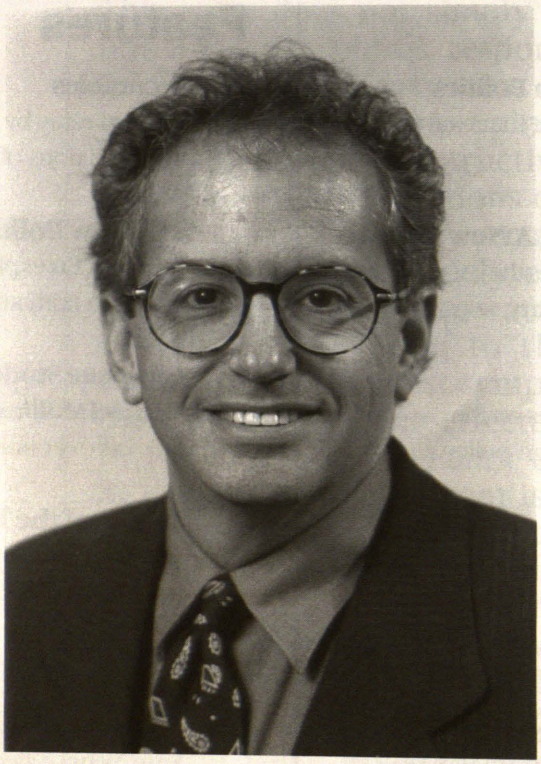
# A NEW POLITICAL ORDER

## AMERICAN POLITICS AFTER SEPTEMBER 11

*By Norman J. Ornstein*



September 11, 2001 changed American life. In one day, America suffered more casualties in its own homeland than any other day in its history. For the first time in our lifetime, Americans all felt vulnerable at home. As President Bush made it clear to the country that we were preparing for a long war on terrorism—perhaps more accurately, a siege on terrorism—he underscored the fact that many things about American life would never be the same again.

Will politics be one of them? The question is an important one. American politics in 2001 are at an interesting and consequential crossroads. The two parties are virtually evenly divided in power and public allegiance. The House of Representatives has the smallest partisan margin in 70 years—a six-seat edge for the Republicans. The Republicans took control of the House for the first time in forty years in 1994, and have held on, with dwindling margins, ever since, but with the majority clearly up for grabs for the foreseeable future. The Senate has gone from a tie following the 2000 elections—the second tie in history, the first in 125 years—to a precarious, one-half vote margin for the Democrats after the defection from Republican ranks to Independent status of Vermont's Jim Jeffords. The presidential election that brought in George W. Bush was the closest in history, with Bush prevailing by one electoral vote out of 538. Surveys show that the party identification of voters with Democrats and Republicans is likewise virtually even.

The 2002 elections will be a major test, with both the House and Senate again at stake. In midterm elections for the House, the President's party almost always loses seats, but the large number of safe seats and a small advantage from the redistricting that followed the 2000 Census have given the Republicans a bulwark against Democratic advances; the experts rate control of the House as a tossup. Democrats should have an advantage in keeping their majority status in the Senate—of the 34 seats in contest next year, 20 are held by Republicans. But an equal or greater number of the most vulnerable seats at stake are held by Democrats, making it a body whose majority is also in play.

It is rare in American history to have a sustained period with parties at parity. Most often, we have had a clear majority party that wins most elections and carries the apparent allegiance of a plurality or majority of the electorate. Divided government has now become the norm, not the exception. It would take a significant shift in the tectonic plates of American politics to see one of the two parties break free and establish an enduring national majority.

Will the vicious terrorist assaults on the World Trade Center and the Pentagon provide the catalyst for a political transformation? The early signs certainly suggest some serious change in the political landscape. Before September 11th, George W. Bush's approval rating hovered between 50 and 55 percent, with a sizable number of Democrats continuing to question his legitimacy as President after the disputed election. After September

11th, Bush's approval rating hit 93 percent, the highest ever measured, with few raising doubts about his status as President. Public approval of other institutions, including Congress, also rose, as did the public's estimation of the Republican Party's ability to deal with terrorism.

Not surprisingly, many commentators began to suggest that this new war on terrorism would solidify George W. Bush's standing, and improve the odds of the Republican Party in the 2002 elections. But there is some reason for skepticism. Wars can shift alliances, change relations among countries, alter power fundamentally in the world and even reshape societies, but not necessarily realign the relative popularity of parties or presidents. It is especially dangerous to take the political alignments that exist at a particular point in time, especially soon after the outbreak of conflict, and assume that they will persist.

Thus, two powerful caveats: George H.W. Bush and Winston Churchill. Bush Sr. reached 91 percent approval as President in the polls soon after the end of the Gulf War in 1991. Less than eighteen months later, he achieved 38 percent support, and was beaten soundly for reelection by Bill Clinton. Winston Churchill emerged from the triumph against the Nazis of World War II to find himself unceremoniously dumped as Prime Minister by the British electorate.

What the Gulf War example suggests is that even seminal events like a war recede quickly from public memory as other events replace them and cascade around people via hundreds of television and radio channels, thousands of Internet sites and other sources of information. What the aftermath of World War II suggests is that the "what have you done for me lately" syndrome exists among voters, and that voters who appreciate the kind of leadership that leads to success in war look for other qualities to deal with domestic issues in a post–war context.

The events of September 11 will nonetheless have an impact on American politics, in the very short run and the medium term at least. The 2001 elections comprise the short run and include three high-profile contests: governorships in New Jersey and Virginia, and the mayoral contest in New York. It seemed likely in August and early September that all three posts, now held by Republicans, would be won by Democrats in November. Post-September 11, a Democratic sweep still seems likely.

## The Short Term Impact

So what is the impact on politics? Had there been no terrorist attack, the headline on newspapers and the lead story in evening news shows on Wednesday, November 7, the day after the election, would have been something like, "Republicans Rejected By Voters." Unfair? Sure—the elections in New Jersey, Virginia and New York are being decided far more on the basis of local factors and individual candidates than national trends. But such contests are always analyzed in national terms.

Pre-September 11th, we were facing the likelihood of a major showdown over the budget—remember the Social Security "lockbox"—between the President and Congress from October 1st well into November, with the President defending his tax cuts and pushing for more defense spending, and Democrats calling for delay or repeal of some of the tax cuts and for more spending on education and health care. A headline like the one above would have deeply undercut the President's negotiating leverage.

Now, even if the election outcomes are the same and the headlines are the same, the political repercussions are not. Most likely, headlines about the 2001 elections will be below-the-fold on the front page, or buried inside the papers. There is no confrontation over the budget, no lockbox, no fight looming between Democrats and Republicans. Chances are the pundits will discuss the election outcomes in more local and parochial terms, and not as evidence of a national trend. So in one important, short-term sense, Republicans may have dodged a political bullet.

**"What the aftermath of World War II suggests is that the "what have you done for me lately" syndrome exists among voters, and that voters who appreciate the kind of leadership that leads to success in war look for other qualities to deal with domestic issues in a post-war context."**

**"If the war ends quickly with a triumph—the capture of bin Laden and the eradication of much of the Al Qaeda network, followed by a pattern of low-level conflict - history would suggest not a huge reward for the party of the President, but no impact at all."**

## The Impact on the 2002 Elections

In the largest sense, it is extremely difficult to predict the impact of a war begun fourteen months before an election on that election. If the war ends quickly with triumph—the capture of Bin Laden and the eradication of much of the Al Qaeda network, followed by a pattern of low-level conflict—history would suggest not a huge reward for the party of the President, but no impact at all. At the conclusion of the Gulf War, pundits confidently predicted the virtual coronation of George Bush and a huge gain for Republicans in the 1992 congressional elections. Republican strategists talked of recruiting dozens of Gulf War veterans to run against Democratic lawmakers who had voted against American military action in the Gulf. Some veterans were recruited, but proved to be largely ineffective candidates. But more generally, by the time the election took place, the war was a distant memory. Democrats lost a dozen seats in the House and gained two seats in the Senate, but not a single contest for the House or the Senate in 1992 turned on the war.

On the other hand, the election impact of the war against terrorism could be enormous. If it is still ongoing next fall, with continuing, major military actions and casualties, or if there are major terrorist incidents along the way that rival the World Trade Center tragedy, voters may be ready to make a statement, nationalizing the congressional elections. But what statement? It could be to reaffirm the status quo, aiding all incumbents; to reject the status quo, hurting many incumbents; or to boost or punish the President's party.

A national trend that assisted incumbents would presumably help Republicans in the House and Democrats in the Senate. But since both chambers will have their majorities decided by a handful of election contests, individual idiosyncrasies in candidates and contests could still make the overall outcomes uncertain. The same conclusion, of course, holds if there were a national trend that hurt incumbents. But in two ways, the events so far should provide a boost to the GOP. The fall season a year before congressional elections is prime time for recruiting candidates. Facing a President with overwhelming approval and a country that is rallying behind all its institutions, potential challengers to Republican incumbents are taking a hard second look at their candidacies. That recruitment effect probably cost Democrats a dozen or more top-flight challengers in 1992, contributing to their losses in the House that year. If the recruitment effect takes hold over the next three months, Democrats' chances of recapturing the House in 2002 will be seriously diminished.

At the same time, the public's perception of which party can best handle terrorism has reinforced a Republican advantage: the public has more confidence in Republicans over Democrats by 56 percent to 21 percent. The numbers on the economy are even for the parties. If war and terror dominate the agenda in the fall of 2001—assuming no debacle—chances are it will play to the political advantage of Republicans. But if the economy has reemerged as the primary issue, that advantage disappears, and may well turn into a serious impediment for them.

## The Impact on the Policy Agenda

The priorities of the President and Congress, which focused around tax cuts, Social Security, patients' rights, Medicare and education, have shifted sharply. Now, anti-terrorism legislation, an economic stimulus package, additional funding for the military and efforts to beef up our intelligence system and our airport security have taken over. The public's priorities, and by extension the nation's policy agenda, have also been dramatically affected by the events of September 11th. The latest Pew Research Center survey shows that the importance to Americans of military and defense issues, and of foreign affairs generally, has in-

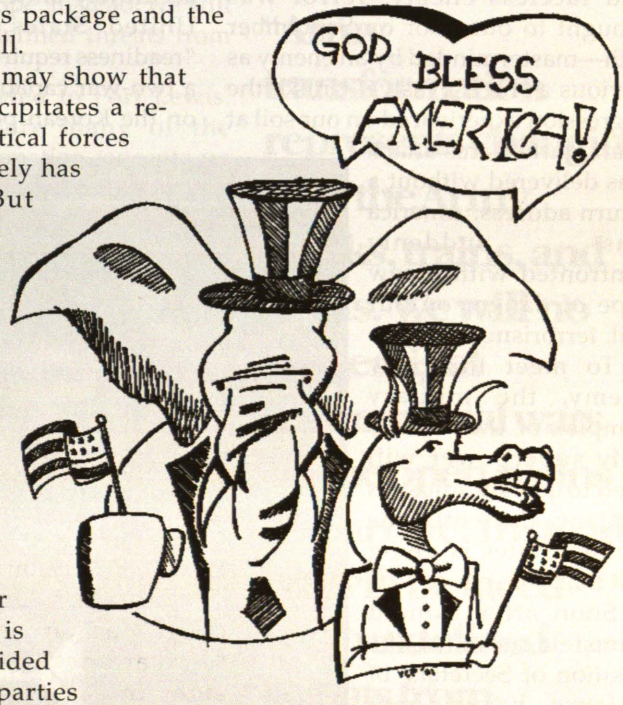
creased by 30 percentage points or so compared to January of this year—35 points up for foreign affairs, from 17 to 52 percent, 29 points up for defense, from 26 to 57 percent. The importance of the economy has also grown, by 20 percentage points (from 34 to 54,) while the importance of other domestic issues like patients' rights, prescription drugs for seniors and education, have declined by 10 to 15 percent. But unless the war on terrorism escalates in a sharp and sustained way, these domestic issues will reemerge, probably sometime in the next year, with noticeably different approaches by the two parties.

## The 2004 Presidential Elections

As I have suggested above, any predictions about how the war on terrorism will affect President George W. Bush's chances for reelection are folly right now. But the events of September 11th and their aftermath will have an impact on the recruitment of candidates to run against the President. Candidates for a presidential nomination who are not independently wealthy have to begin organizing and campaigning for the nomination at least two years before the election. In the wake of the Gulf War, with then-President George H.W. Bush riding high in the polls, a number of Democrats who would have considered a run against him opted out—leaving an obscure young governor from Arkansas, despite his lack of foreign policy experience, with a smaller field to run against and a substantial advantage to win his party's nomination. Will candidates who lack deep foreign policy experience, like John Edwards of North Carolina, feel emboldened by the Clinton experience or cowed by the public focus on foreign policy and defense? Will Al Gore or Joe Lieberman, with expertise in international affairs, gain a comparative advantage? Potential presidential candidates are already beginning preliminary efforts to line up experienced staff, setting fundraising timetables and planning campaigns. The events of the next year, including the conduct of the war, will shape their efforts and decisions.

Americans responded to the unprecedented attack on our soil by rallying behind the flag, the President, our institutions and reinforcing a strong sense of community. As has happened in the past, a crisis brought out the best in America. It will likely stay that way for some time, since the threat will be present for a long time. But, just as in previous wars, public commitment to the war effort may wax and wane, and the political process will revert to form as soon as it can. Indeed, it already has, just weeks after the initial horrific attack, on the economic stimulus package and the airport security bill.

The long term may show that this new war precipitates a realignment of political forces in America. It surely has that potential. But there is nothing now to suggest that it will favor Republicans over Democrats, or vice versa. It will probably result in a more vigorous and active federal government. However, the most likely long-term prognosis for American politics is a fluid, closely divided system with two parties at virtual parity, with a country largely in the middle and parties, at least at the politician and activist level, continuing to move towards the ideological ends. Under crisis, we will find ways to govern, to act expeditiously and to unite. But as the immediacy of the crisis fades, the difficulty of building majority coalitions to govern will increase.




*Norman J. Ornstein received his PhD from the University of Michigan and is a Resident Scholar at the American Enterprise Institute for Public Policy Research. He is an analyst for CBS and writes regularly for* USA Today, The New York Times, *and* The Washington Post.

# A NEW WAR, A NEW ENEMY, A NEW ARMY

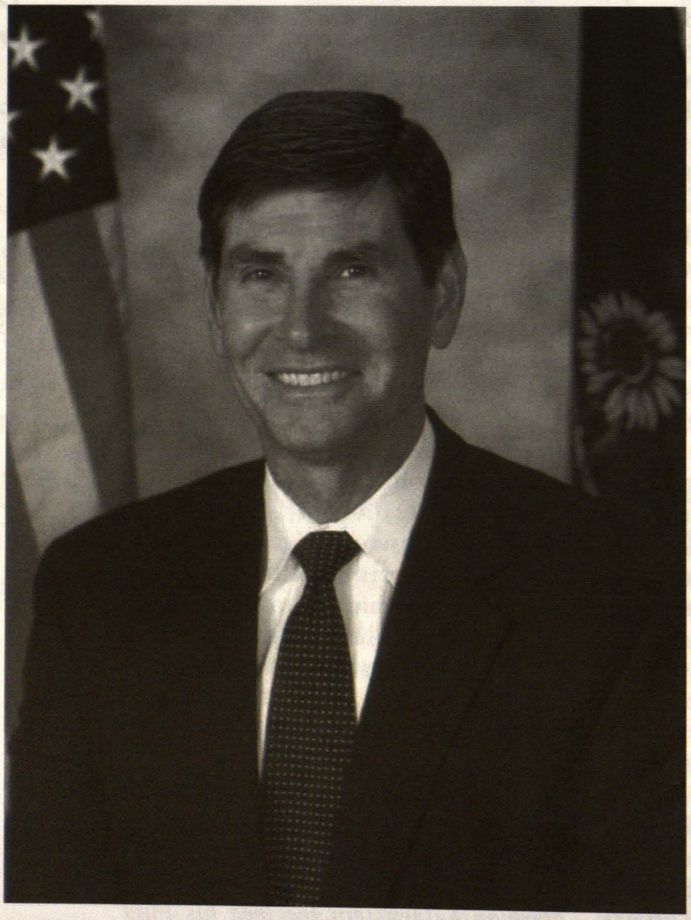
## TRANSFORMING THE ARMY

*By Congressman Jim Ryun*

Our nation recently suffered a devastating blow from a new and faceless enemy. Terror was brought to our door on September 11th—masterminded by an enemy as devious as he is evasive. Unlike the aggression experienced on our soil at Pearl Harbor, this attack was delivered without a return address. America was suddenly confronted with a new type of danger on our soil: terrorism.

To meet this new enemy, the military complex of the world's only superpower will need to quickly adjust its strategy. Currently, the United States is doing just that.

Soon after Donald Rumsfeld assumed the position of Secretary of Defense, he was met with the challenge of developing a new military strategy. Every four years, our military leaders conduct a study to formulate our future military strategy in light of our changing world. This study results in the Quadrennial Defense Review (QDR), a blueprint for our national security.



Planners of the new design were faced with several complicating post-Cold War factors. The threats facing the United States are no longer conventional, no longer familiar and no longer static. In past QDRs, military experts were able to accurately anticipate threats to the United States. They formed a "readiness requirement" that dictated a two-war capability, expected to be on the Korean peninsula and in the oil-rich Persian Gulf. However, after September 11th, attacks on our own soil became a reality.

Since 1997, our military has also been required to respond to "asymmetric" or multiple threats like the unanticipated attack on the USS Cole. Additionally, maintaining a peacekeeping presence in places like Bosnia-Herzegovina has forced our military to function as a world stabilizer. Such missions are no longer a choice for the United States. Rather, they are a requirement.

Clearly, we must continue to plan for unfamiliar but inevitable threats that will emerge in decades to come. The 2001 QDR broadens the strategy for our response to these threats. It is not time for business as usual, but rather a time to consider how the world has been altered, and how capabilities have changed. Preparations for the future must be planned.

Delivered at the end of September, the 2001 QDR has indeed produced a more expansive agenda. This new defense blueprint includes strategies for Balkan-like skirmishes and terrorist threats. Readiness requirements necessary to fight one war while holding an enemy's advances in another part of the world are still included. However, the ability to carry out smaller contingencies, in addition to assuring homeland defense, missile defense and anti-terrorism, has further augmented the new defense strategy.

As a runner and former Olympic athlete, I understand the need to train at the highest level in order to maintain competitiveness with others

in the world. Without continual preparation and dogged perseverance, no one can expect to maintain an edge over tough competitors. Now, as a member of the U.S. House of Representatives Armed Services Committee, I believe in applying this principle to our military as well.

I have always been committed to the Army transformation process. Two years ago, the Chief of Staff of the Army, General Eric Shinseki, first introduced this process in order to help the Army meet the future needs of our nation. Long before other leaders were thinking about the shape that future warfare might take, General Shinseki emerged with a vision for the Army. Before the recent elections and reconsideration of the QDR, when "transformation" became a military buzzword, General Shinseki recognized the need for the Army to remain relevant in a world of new threats and unforeseen conflicts.

For a half century, the U.S. Army was organized and equipped to meet America's security needs for the Cold War. Now the Army has begun to reorganize and re-equip itself. The new Army will use lighter equipment and be faster and more versatile.

The process of Army transformation will not be an easy one. General Shinseki's critics did not believe we were accurately anticipating the future of warfare. Still, he was faced with the Army's slow deployment performance in Desert Storm. It took a total of six months to get the Army's heavily armored divisions onto the battlefield in the desert. The lighter forces, comprising airborne and air assault & mountain divisions, however, were able to get to the conflict quickly. Unfortunately, they lacked the ability to resist enemy firepower once they arrived—they lacked survivability.

The failure prompted the new concept around which transformation was based: the Army would become a lighter and more mobile force, while still sustaining survivability. To correct the rapid deployment capability shortfalls, Army transformation requires the ability to put a combat-capable brigade anywhere in the world within 96 hours, a full division in 120 hours, and five divisions on the ground within 30 days.

When General Shinseki unveiled his blueprint for Army transformation, his description was clear and concise: "Soldiers on Point for the Nation Persuasive in Peace, Invincible in War." Carrying out the plan requires that readiness continue to be the Army's top priority. Army transformation represents the sweeping measures that will accomplish the Army's vision, changing the ways that the Army thinks, trains, and fights. We will no longer fight conventional wars on the open plains of Europe. Instead, we will be faced with undefined threats from multiple sources.

I recently traveled to Fort Lewis, Washington, where many of the innovative transformation concepts are being implemented. I was able to look at the light-armored vehicle that will be used by the Army in its interim step toward full transformation. This impressive vehicle will effectively serve the needs of our interim force by combining the mobility needed for peacekeeping efforts with sufficient troop protection.

The Army has also been designated as the executive agent for homeland defense. In coordinating this mission to protect our citizens, Congress should bolster funding for the Army National Guard's Weapons of Mass Destruction Civil Support Teams. These "first responders" worked in New York in the aftermath of September 11th to set up emergency communications networks and air quality testing. Currently, however, these civil support teams have only been appropriated in 10 of the 32 states authorized to receive them.

We are facing a new war and fighting a new enemy. Thanks to the leadership of President Bush, Defense Secretary Rumsfeld, and General Shinseki, we will build a new Army to meet these challenges.

*Congressman Jim Ryun is in his third term representing the Second District of Kansas. He is a member of the Armed Services, Budget and Financial Services Committees.*

**"Army transformation represents changing how the Army thinks, trains, and fights. We will no longer fight conventional wars on the open plains of Europe. Instead, we will be faced with undefined threats from multiple sources."**

# STROBE TALBOTT

## THE GLOBAL CENTURY: THE EFFECTS OF GLOBALIZATION ON FOREIGN POLICY

### AN INTERVIEW

Interview conducted 10/10/01

**Yale's Journal of Politics:** *In this crisis, how long can we expect allied support to last?*

**Strobe Talbott:** The willingness of the coalition, and particularly the Islamic and Arabic members of the coalition, depends on a number of factors. First of all, duration. If bombs are still falling by publication of this issue, I think the coalition will begin to fray around the edges. A protracted bombing campaign is almost by nature going to be an unsuccessful one, both in its military objectives, and its ability to maintain coalition support. The other problem is the reality and the perception, which are not identical, of civilian casualties. If there are a lot of civilian casualties, or if the propaganda machine, which is in some way sympathetic to the terrorists and opposed to the United States, makes it appear that there are a lot of casualties, that will deal a serious blow to the military. Another factor in the effectiveness of the bombing is what the purpose of this bombing is perceived to be. The ostensible purpose, the stated purpose, is to get Osama bin Laden and his network. My own judgment is that this is very unlikely. My own view is that while the administration and its military partners sincerely want to inflict a lot of damage on Osama bin Laden and his network, and while they deny that the objective is regime change, in fact, they hope the consequence of the bombing is the fall of the Taliban and the coming of a government in Kabul that is inhospitable to terrorists and will provide political stability in the region.

**YJP:** *Do you think the Northern Alliance will be able to provide that needed stability in the region?*

**ST:** The Northern Alliance is a rag-tag coalition, ethnically tilted towards the Tajiks, one of many constituent groups. The Pushtun people are not terribly well represented and that's one reason that they're talking about some sort of collaborative arrangement with the King, but there is reason for skepticism about the viability of that or any other alternative to the Taliban. Also, it's hard to imagine any other government being worse than the Taliban. One of the lessons of this whole experience is that when you operate on the principle of "the enemy of my enemy is my friend," you're likely to end up with a very unfriendly new reality. The Taliban and indeed Osama bin Laden are, in a way, creations or unintended consequences of the American policy of supporting anyone who was against the Soviets in Afghanistan. It led to, in the near term, what I think was an absolutely critical defeat for the Soviet Union, as their defeat in Afghanistan helped create conditions that led to the of ending the Cold War. That's a big deal, historically. But the first Bush administration and indeed the Clinton administration turned their backs on these guys. And now what are they doing? Afghanistan just festered and the Taliban came to power and opened its arms to Osama bin laden. Now we have this mess. I hope that's a lesson that everyone has learned. It's a point that PM Blair has brought up in every major speech. He has repeatedly said, "we cannot walk away this time." He's been saying that more loudly and more convincingly than the U.S. spokesmen.

**YJP:** *Within the context of the previous failures of the Soviets in Afghanistan, what does the U.S. have to fear in Afghanistan? Will a directed bombing campaign be enough?*

**ST:** The rationale for bringing down the Taliban is pretty simple. Of all the regimes on the face of the earth, this one has been more aggressive and defiant in giving aid to terrorists, and part of the theory behind this is that if nothing else, let's take away a government in Kabul that aids and abets terrorists even if we can't get the terrorists themselves. That has some logic to it as long as it can be done relatively quickly, and with relatively little damage to innocent civilians. As for what's next, there aren't a whole lot of military options. When I was in Turkey, there was a lot of concern about Iraq being on the target list. There are members of the press in the Bush administration that have advocated putting Iraq on the target list. That view hasn't carried the day, and I think that's a good thing. Saddam is a really bad

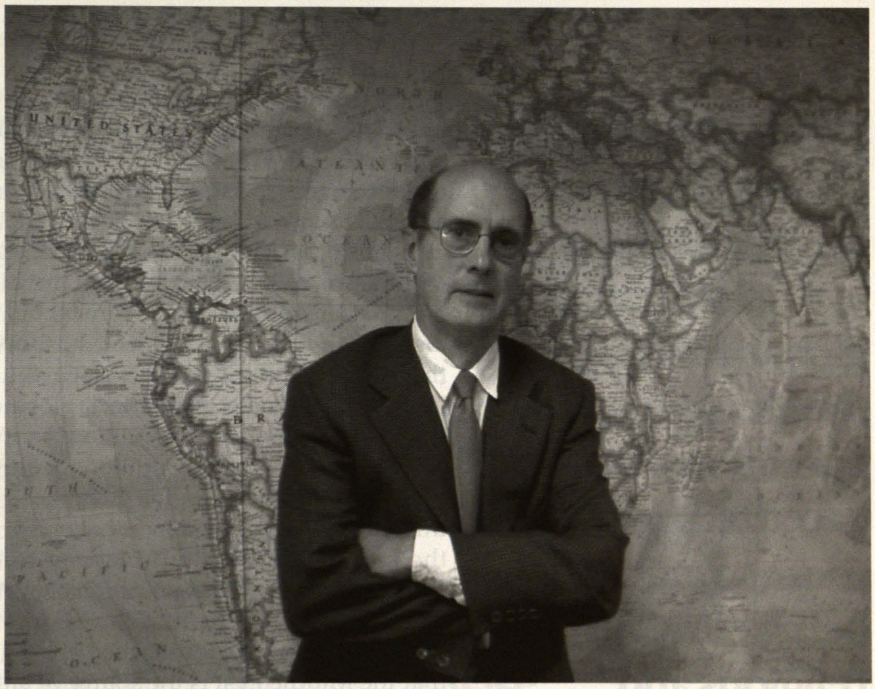
actor and the sooner the world is rid of him, the safer the world will be, no doubt about that. But absent of any evidentiary link with Osama bin laden and Saddam Hussein I think it would be dangerous given the uncertainties and instabilities in the region as a whole to go start a war with Saddam.

**YJP:** *As a Soviet expert, do you think that in the long run this conflict will bring Russia and the U.S. closer together as allies, and change the fundamental nature of their relationship?*

**ST:** It already has changed their relationship quite dramatically. Partly because the agenda of U.S.-Russian relations went from being very complex and somewhat tension-ridden to very simple. It went from being an agenda that included everything from sponsorship of democracy in Russia, to energy development, to trying to get the Russians to stop their scorched earth policy in Chechnya, to national military defense to now an essentially a one-issue agenda: stopping terrorism. Since the Russians themselves have been victims of terrorism, and have depicted everyone along their southern rim against them as being a terrorist, it was very easy for Putin to say, "I'm with you." He was the first foreign leader to call President Bush. Beyond that, he provided intelligence, supported the U.S. in the Security Council, didn't complain when the U.S. invoked article 5, and, most dramatically, gave the nod to the Uzbeks for letting the Americans go into Uzbekistan. This is a big change for the Russians to tolerate and even support the American military in the region. It has had a positive impact on the atmosphere and substance of U.S.-Russian relations, but a lot of the core issues remain. Sooner or later, when the U.S. recovers from the trauma and goes back to pursuing a broad agenda, all those issues are still going to be there.

**YJP:** *How will the U.S.'s relationship change in regard to Chechnya? The Soviets consider the Chechens terrorists, but we have continually condemned them for their actions against the Chechens. Will it be hypocritical to change our stance?*

**ST:** That is a question for the administration. I hope that they will continue to make the point to the Russians that if you treat an entire people as terrorists, you're going to have a lot more problems than if you pursue a discriminatory policy that deals with incurably violent people as such, but doesn't radicalize the population as a whole. They have alienated the population through their indiscriminate attacks. I worry that Putin will feel like he has much more license from the U.S. and the international community in regard to the tactics he pursues in Chechnya and will step up the violence or at least not step it down and the result will be more problems in the Caucuses.



**"In many ways the events of September 11, for better or for worse, have proved that our fate is inextricably bound to the rest of the world."**

**YJP:** *Where will the U.S. be after this conflict, say, five years down the road? Do you predict isolationism or a broader involvement in foreign affairs?*

**ST:** I think you can rule out isolationism. First of all, I don't think isolationism has been a live issue for decades. In many ways the events of September 11, for better or for worse, have proved that our fate is inextricably bound to the rest of the world. What the terrorists were able to do was turn our great strengths against us. Our openness as a society, our mobility, the fact that we are plugged into the world in so many ways, helped them ride the phenomenon of globalization and modernization right into the

**"My own strong view is that in the long haul, the need is to to attack global poverty, and the many conditions that breed terrorism; those conditions being ethnic, religious and regional conflict."**

center, killing a lot of people and destroying two great symbols of not just our system, but the international system. The challenge is how can we, in concert with others, make it much harder for terrorists to do that ever again. My conviction is that there is no answer to that, but there are a number of ways to reduce the danger. One is going after not just the terrorists, but also those who support and harbor them. My own strong view is that in the long haul, the need is to attack global poverty, and the many conditions that breed terrorism; those conditions being ethnic, religious and regional conflict. I think there is some evidence that one of the components of the American response to this is an intensification of our diplomatic engagement in the Middle East. I am not one of those who believes that the Middle East is the source of all problems in the world or even the source of all terrorism, but there is no question that the festering Arab-Israeli conflict has been a major influence in the region and has stoked the fires that terrorists are constantly trying to light. We have more of an incentive than ever to really put our all into the Middle East peace process.

**YJP:** *What do you see as the role of the Yale Globalization Center in all of this?*

**ST:** When Nayan Chanda, Avery Davis, Haynie Wheeler, and I talked about our mission here exactly a month ago, we talked in terms of globalization being a complex phenomenon that had a lot of danger and bad news in it. September 11 has been a horrendous wake up call for the world, as well as the U.S. about some of the dangers of globalization, including that of terrorism. YCSG, like the University, has discussed the problems associated with globalization, the danger of clash of civilizations, the dangers of fanaticism, the danger of the openness of modern society and we have further incentive to focus on these aspects of the problem. We cannot let

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this event, traumatic and significant as it is, be the be-all end-all of our understanding of what's going on. One of the ways that the University can be constructive in the public debate is to inform ourselves, the public, our government, and other governments about the complexities, and not allow the simplicities, which are often irresistible, blot out the complexities of the world. We are in the complexity business. Politicians, and I don't mean this critically, are in the simplicity business. People in public policy can sometimes be too simple to be wise. There is a natural tendency after something like this to say, "Everything in defense policy has to be towards one thing, getting the terrorists." There will be an element of that, but we must maintain peripheral vision. It is not contradictory to look at other problems like economic development, conflict resolution and other things. I think that Yale and the Globalization Center can be a voice for that whole set of issues.

*Strobe Talbott, Deputy Secretary of State from 1994 to 2001 and a key architect of U.S. foreign policy for the past eight years, returned to Yale in July 200 as professor in the field of International Relations and Director of the new Yale Center for the Study of Globalization. Talbott is a 1968 graduate of Yale College and a former trustee of the University. He entered public service after 21 years as an award-winning journalist for Time magazine, where he was editor-at-large, foreign affairs columnist, Washington bureau chief, State Department correspondent and White House correspondent. Talbott has served as a Director of the Council on Foreign Relations and the Carnegie Endowment for International Peace, a trustee of the Trilateral Commission and a member of the Aspen Strategy Group.*

**"We are in the complexity business. Politicians, and I don't mean this critically, are in the simplicity business. People in public policy can sometimes be too simple to be wise."**


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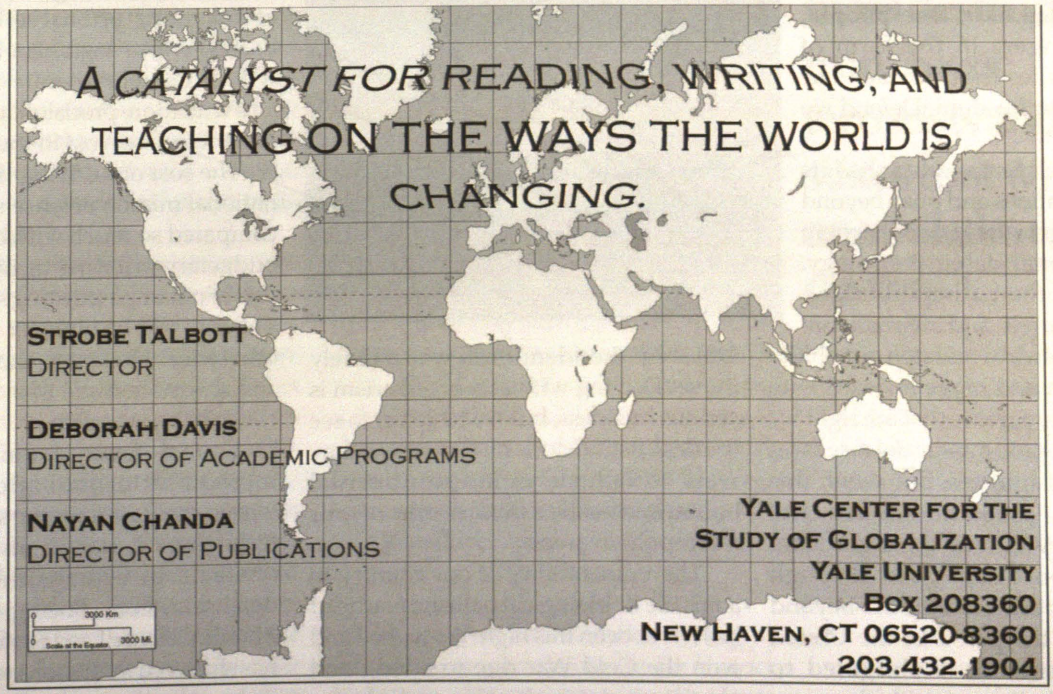


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# DEFEND WE MUST

## MISSILE DEFENSE IN THE 21ST CENTURY

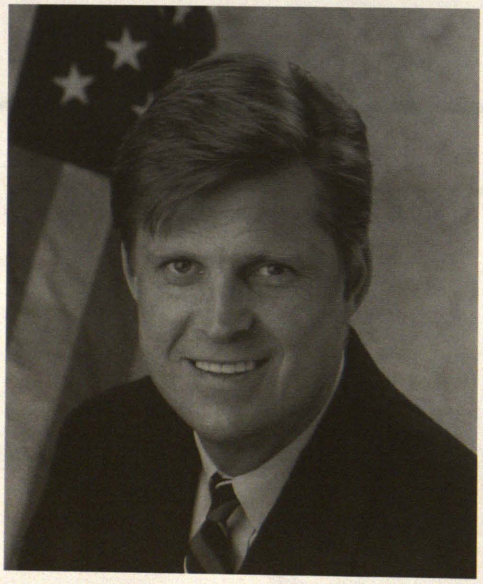
*By Congressman Todd Tiahrt*

The ordination conferred upon "We the People" when thirty-nine delegates signed the United States Constitution September 17, 1787, charged our government to "insure domestic tranquility" and "provide for the common defense" of this great nation. A Revolution had shaken the foundations of the Thirteen Colonies, compelling them to defend their inalienable rights. A tyrannical regime threatened the Colonists' rights to life and to liberty. Today, a new battle rages.

As a member of Congress, I have sworn to uphold the constitutional mandate of providing for our national defense against threats to our existence as a free people. Present dangers in the form of ballistic missiles now threaten our right to live in freedom. Defend we must.

The United States must shed its present limitations and push beyond its boundaries in the quest for a more secure national defense strategy. Technology, the national budget, domestic quarrels, and international politics will always threaten our ability to implement and move forward with policies and programs that are right for America. National missile defense faces a plethora of hurdles, but when this country is presented with the presidential will and the significant public support expressed through Congress to push our abilities beyond the realm of the possible, the United States government is obligated to answer the challenges with the same steel of American resolve that landed a man on the moon in 1969.

The ash of destruction from September 11 still permeates the American landscape, both literally and figuratively. The President and Congress have taken immediate steps to respond to the national security threats now exposed, but the U.S. must aggressively implement the long-term elements necessary for a balanced homeland national security policy. The creation of the Homeland Security



Office by President Bush was a timely move. Dealing with acts of terrorism is serious business, but we have yet to see the destruction done by terrorists if they were to launch an intercontinental ballistic missile toward one of our metropolitan areas.

The vulnerability of our country to a missile or biological ballistic warhead has never been this high. We waged and won the Cold War due to a long and persistent determination to fight for freedom and democracy. We now wage a new war against a web of rogue terrorists and nations. This network is currently being dismantled by a sophisticated coalition of powerful countries working together. However, the ability of rogue states to unite and bring mass destruction on us should be a wakeup call that the American people heed. Only a naive nation would believe it is protected from even greater attacks than were witnessed on September 11.

National missile defense is a time-worn concept the American public has heard for decades. Most believe we already have mechanisms in place to shield us from a ballistic missile attack and that the defense community just desires an upgrade. In some circles, missile defense is nothing more than a science fiction dream of government officials with inflated agendas. Both these ideas are misconceptions that must be addressed through an aggressive public information campaign. The truth is we are totally vulnerable to mass destruction because we have no missile defense system.

Without such protection on the home front, we will face escalating obstacles in our dealings with aggressive terrorist networks that may gain access to state-owned weapons of mass destruction. With a defense system in place to guard against such attacks, our offensive strategies in dealing with a vagrant or hostile enemy will ultimately operate more swiftly and with more precision, yielding fewer American lives lost in the process.

The cost of fulfilling the dream of a national missile defense should not be compared so much with other national budgetary priorities as much as to the cost of not implementing such a system. The cost will be high; let no one tell us otherwise. However, the price of not acting is more costly than anyone could conceivably imagine.

Our defense team has made incredible technological progress within the past few years proving that technology is not an insurmountable obstacle in establishing a missile defense system. Boeing, the National Missile Defense Lead System Integrator, has shattered limitations we were facing only months ago. Ground-Based Interceptors, X-Band Radars, communication infrastructures, Upgraded Early Warning Radars and interfaces to Space-Based Infrared

System satellites are some of the tools Boeing is engineering so the national missile defense system will deliver accurate and effective results.

Many who are opposed to missile defense protection say that testing shows that we cannot move forward. The facts support the opposite conclusion. Fourteen out of sixteen hit-to-kill tests have succeeded, providing our defense and research teams with end-game data each time the tests occurred.

The United States has a proven history of defending peace—both domestically and internationally. If we are to continue fulfilling our role of being a light of democracy for the world, we must be protected against mass destruction from rogue terrorists and evil states that wish annihilation as our destiny.

Congress and the American people must meet President Bush's challenge by giving him the support and political thrust needed to hammer out missile defense architectural problems. In July of this year, Lt. Gen. Ronald Kadish, Director of the Ballistic Missile Defense Organization, said the United States must go "beyond the conventional build-to-requirements acquisition process."

As a member of Congress who sits on the Appropriations Subcommittee on Defense, I believe we must place a much higher priority on the pursuit of a national missile defense system. Limitations on funding for defense are limitations on our existence as a world leader of freedom. Without protection, we will lose our ability to act as a broker of peace in an unstable world.

We know that five of the seven nations that the United States has identified as sponsoring terrorism are currently developing weapons of mass destruction. Our vulnerability is not a future threat that will suddenly take care of itself if we bury our heads in the sand. Three decades ago there were only nine nations with the capabilities and technology to launch ballistic missiles. Today, that threat has mushroomed to more than thirty nations – each with the ability to deliver a nuclear, chemical or biological package on the doorstep of an American city. The time has come for the United States to stop playing make-believe concerning the defense we need for our homeland.

North Korea, Pakistan, Iran, India and China are states that have made recent advances in their ability to launch long-range ballistic missiles. These countries have ongoing programs that are fine-tuning and testing actual missile systems. Potentially more alarming is that our intelligence has identified at least 25 countries that, we believe, have in their possession or are actively seeking nuclear, biological or chemical weapons.

Progress, however, is being made on the international front. Russia and the United States have recently escalated their level of cooperation and consultation with each other in regards to the 1972 Anti-ballistic Missile (ABM) Treaty. The former Soviet Union regime was an enemy of the United States — Russia is now a friend. We will only return to old ways if we do not move beyond our 1970s style of discussions. Much good has come from the ABM Treaty. Let's take that good and infuse it into the 21st century relationship that exists between our two countries. The global threat demands it. The security of the United States requires it.

Speaking on the ABM Treaty at the National Defense University, President Bush said, "We need a new framework that allows us to build missile defenses to counter the different threats of today's world." Since the President's call to move "beyond the constraints" of the ABM Treaty, we can no longer think in terms of "if," but rather in terms of "when" and "how."

Diplomacy has always been crucial in the U.S. tool chest of dealing with other countries. But now we must again assume the role of leadership that the world has historically come to recognize and eventually rely upon. Remaining in firm partnership with our allies, the U.S. must take the next step forward in protecting our territory by constructing a missile defense shield. As long as we show democratic resolve and good will toward our allies, they should have no fear of us as the friendly neighbor.

Defend we must.

*Congressman Todd Tiahrt is currently in his third term representing the 4th District of Kansas. He was named to the House Appropriations Committee in 1997 and to the position of Deputy Majority Whip in this Congress. He also serves on the Subcommittee on Defense.*

**"The United States has a proven history of defending peace. If we are to continue fulfilling our role as a light of democracy for the world, we must be protected against mass destruction from rogue terrorists and evil states that wish annihilation as our destiny."**

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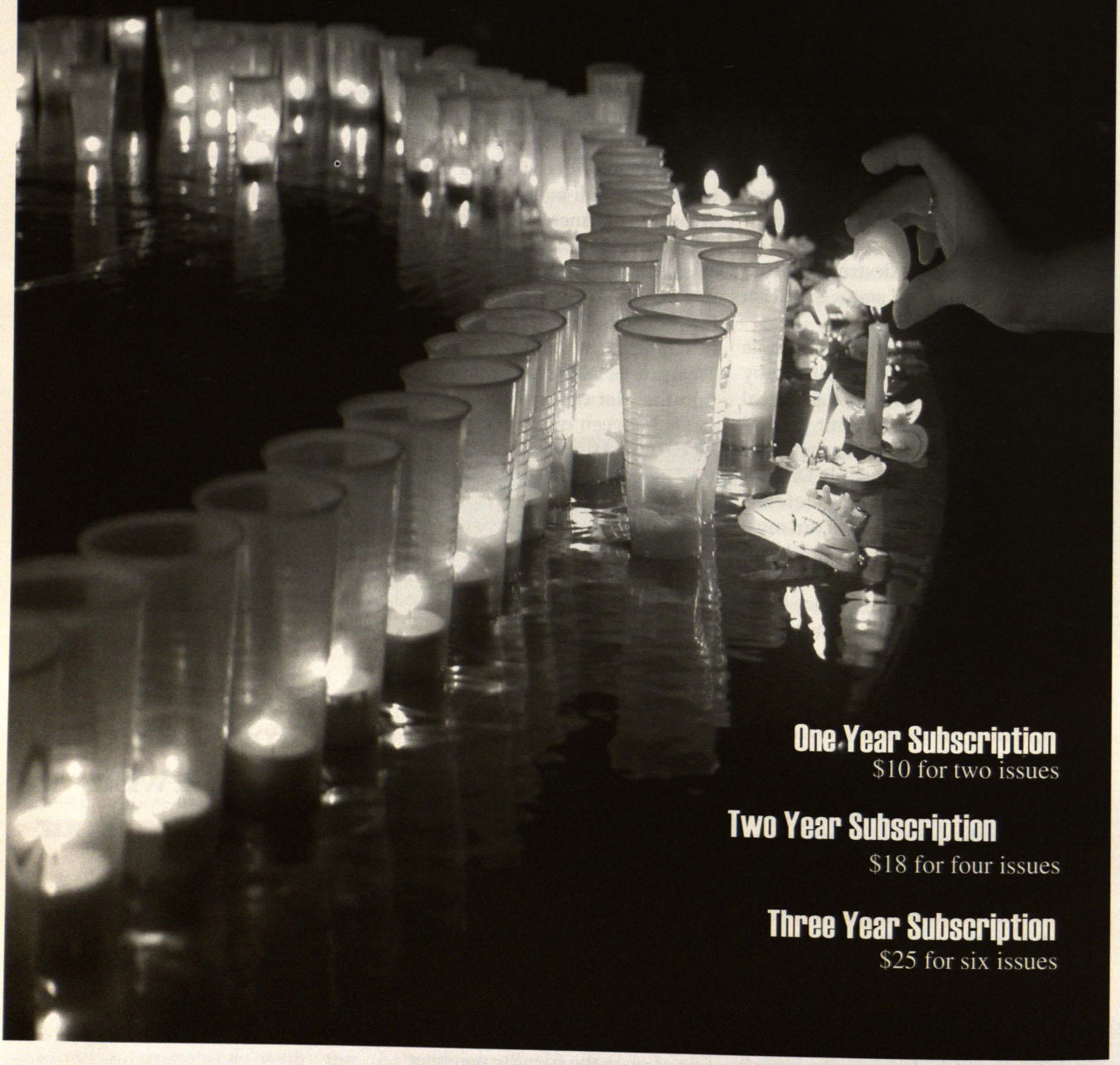

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# GARY HART

## THE FUTURE OF AMERICAN DEFENSE

### AN INTERVIEW

***Former Senator Gary Hart was a member of a commission that recently released the Hart-Rudman Report, which anticipated future security threats to America. The staff of The Politic sat down with Senator Hart on October 2nd to discuss the impact of the events of September 11.***

**Yale's Journal of Politics:** *Could you give our readers a general summary of your commissioned report?*

**Gary Hart:** The history of it goes back to when the commission was created by a joint agreement between former President Clinton and former Speaker Newt Gingrich in order to review American national security doctrines and structures post-Cold War. The agreement would be a fourteen-person commission, half democratic and half republican, comprising former office holders, former military commanders, and former cabinet members. A timetable of about two and a half years was set to make the final report to the next President. We cast our net as broadly as our mandate would let us, in terms of overall principles and themes. We had an artificially set deadline of a quarter century. Not even the wildest exotic futurists could think beyond that framework and even then you are pushing the envelope of imagination as to how the world would look. Given the first quarter of the 21st century, we discussed what kind of world would this be, what are the new realities, particularly how would it be different from the 20th century.

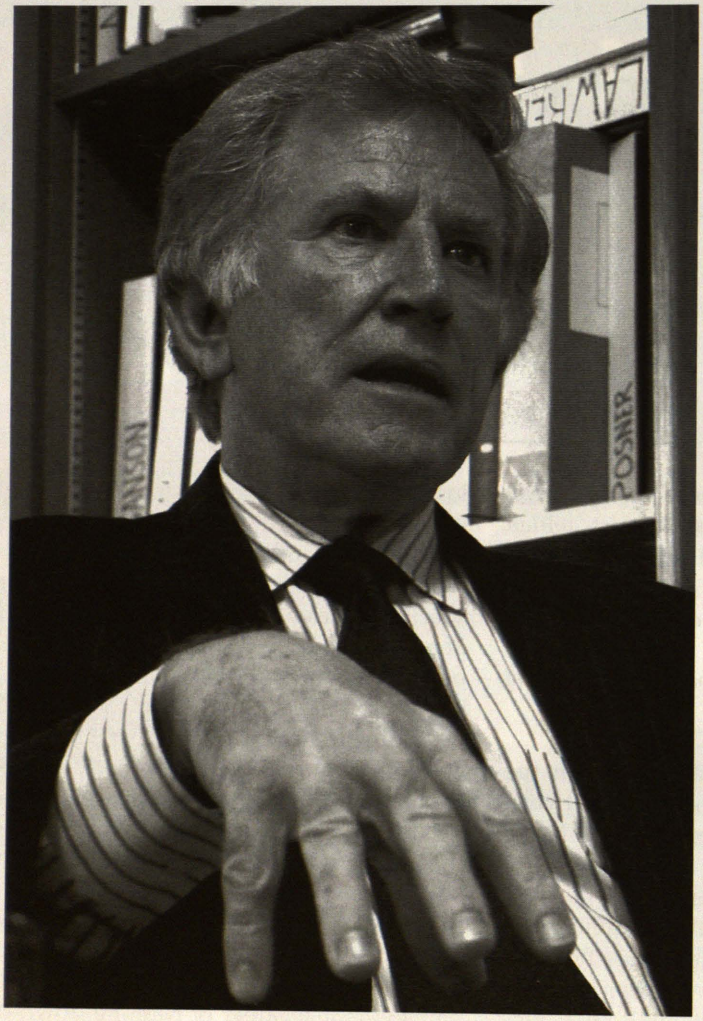
Our first report, "New World Coming," came out September 15, 1999 and that was the one that stated that in all likelihood America would be attacked on our soil, and Americans would possibly lose their lives in large numbers. It didn't get a lot of attention with that dramatic finding but we then went ahead with our second step, to create a new national security framework. The final report discussed how to implement that framework. We presented the final report to the President at the end of January and we briefed Secretaries Powell and Rumsfeld and NSA Dr. Rice and teams in their offices. They pretty well understood where we were headed.

There were five major areas that we looked at. First was homeland security. Second was restructuring the institutions. We felt the State Department to be a crippled institution and recommended very strongly to change the way it did business. Also, the Department of Defense needed major reorganizations as well as the NSA. We also found we were falling behind in education in general and specifically scientific education, and found that to be a pillar of a new National Security agenda. We also identified the need for Congress to reorganize itself. The committees and subcommittees are too dysfunctional. And it ends up that people in the administration spend half their lives testifying before committees and committee chairs. And then finally, we found the caliber and quality of people entering pubic service, uniformed and un-uniformed, civil servants and diplomats and so on, had declined measurably over the last quarter of a century. This has become a national security issue in that you couldn't run the Government or a National Security operation without attracting better people. That was quite dramatic, particularly for the Republicans who had so made a career of running down the Government. This was a huge change of direction for a lot of people. Homeland security, we felt was scattered and dysfunctional and disorganized and had to be organized in a new agency, not an office or council.

That has been the principle topic of discussion obviously since the 11th of September: how should we structure homeland security? Start with FEMA, as the core then bring in the uniformed border agencies, the Coast Guard, Border Patrol and Customs. Don't change their name, character or structure, but bring them under a different head, whereas they each report to a different cabinet officer now and that simply doesn't work. This agency should not be an intelligence collection agency, but should have the authority to target intelligence that would be useful so it can approach the CIA or NSA. It should not be a military agency either, so not a part of the Department of Defense. Its quasi-military arm should be the National Guard. The report was delivered eight months ago, but not acted on very much.

**YJP**: *Why do you think it didn't receive the media attention that it deserved when it was released?*

**GH:** Several factors: one is too many people saw us as just another commission. This was a unique operation. There




were a number of other commissions looking at terrorism at the same time. However, our mandate and structure were unprecedented, since 1947, since the end of WWII and the beginning of the Cold War. And even then, if you look at that history, which is particularly interesting now, in 1947 and 1948, we were coming out of WWII and everybody thought we would disarm and retreat to pre-WWII America, but Russia maintained its army and was taking over countries. George Kennan's memos started circulating, with the containment of Communism. Various committees and commissions started thinking about America's role in the world going forward, what role we were going to play, as a leader of western democracy, containers of Communism. From that came a permanent Department of Defense, separate Air Force, breaking it off from the army, creation of the Central Intelligence Committee and a director of the CIA as well as the passage of the National Security Act of 1947, which laid the framework for conducting the old war. So, nothing like that had happened since 1947 until our commission came along.

I think we were simply unsuccessful in convincing the establishment and the national press as to the importance of this, and it wasn't for lack of trying. We visited editorial boards of *The New York Times* and *The Washington Post* and *The Wall Street Journal* and when the final report came out, we did something I didn't like. We hired a PR firm to try to get media attention to this. We did work the halls of Congress and convinced some members of both parties to think seriously about this. But in the final analysis, one could talk about the media preoccupation about trivial scandals, Elian Gonzales, shark attacks, Congressman Condit, etc. That is an important question and someone should take a look at it, something deeper than our commission. What's important to the media, what do people want to see and hear in the 21st century? And I hope somebody will treat that as a systemic and endemic problem in our society.

**YJP:** *Now that this report does have the attention of the American government and the entire American community, to what extent do you believe the findings of your report can be implemented? Does the American government have a free mandate to do what it needs to do to counter terrorism?*

**GH:** When we debated, virtually all our deliberations were public, with all our findings posted on the Internet. Let me say, by the way, the final report got a lot of attention through the Internet. Each of the reports were downloaded or visited tens if not hundreds of thousands of times and the final report had close to 2 million hits and over 250,000 people downloaded a 150 pg report, so somebody out there was paying attention. It was a bestseller. What we ran up against pre-Sept 11th was bureaucratic resistance. Departments simply did not to give up authority. Bureaucratic inertia was a big argument against it. I would like to hear any Department Secretary

argue that it is more important for his or her Department to keep one of these agencies than for the United States to be more secure. So if the President moved quickly and got Congress to join him, the bureaucratic argument goes away. Then it's just a question of how you want it structured.

The President's first speech before a joint Congress emphasized the phrase, "Office of Homeland Security." So we won that battle, at least. However, he announced that it be a council led by Governor Ridge, parallel in structure to the National Security Council. The office approach wasn't good, but the council approach is much worse in my judgment. Two examples, in the 1970s we had an energy crisis, and President Nixon appointed a White House officer to be the energy czar in 1974, who had no power until the establishment of the Department of Energy. The second is the drug czar in the White House, with cabinet rank, whatever that means, but no authority. He gets the Department of Justice and the DEA and all these other people to help; but he is a coordinator. He does not have true authority. So it's an important issue: how the government comes out on this will determine if it is in fact an effective operation.

**YJP:** *In addition to bureaucratic resistance, what social resistance do you foresee, as far as infringing on civil liberties?*

**GH:** It's an abstract question that is hard to answer in the abstract. I draw distinctions between rights, liberties and conveniences. For example, one can say an American has a right to carry a shopping bag into a theater, which is true. But maybe the theater is mandated to look into that shopping bag. So instead of just buying your ticket to the movies and walking in, an employee of the theater says I want to look in the shopping bag. Have you sacrificed a right? I don't think so. You have been inconvenienced, but this has been going on in airports since the age of terrorist hijackings. I think what we are going to see is a wave of inconveniences.

My strong feeling, as a former officeholder and someone who knows a good bit about how this country thinks, is that there will be enormous resistance to any infringement on genuine rights, such as privacy and so on. The battlegrounds obviously will be the rules for wiretapping, surveillance, mail-opening, which frankly we have been struggling with for fifty years since WWII and the Cold War. Any time you are in a war time footing, particularly when the war has come to our doorstep, you are right on the margin of what is and what is not a constitutional protected liberty. That's why we have the Supreme Court. This is what they do. They say you have gone too far, yes, this is ok. They are the umpires; they are calling the balls and strikes. Congress will do its best and believe me, they will say that it is important to protect ourselves physically, but it is equally important, if not more so, that we protect what the nature of our society is.

**YJP**: *Can you speculate as to what the long-term consequences for our country will be, say twenty years down the road?*

**GH:** No, that's much too far. I can only see five to ten years tops. It will change our lifestyles along the margins of what I would call inconvenience. Not the full Israeli scrutiny, but 25% to 50% in that direction, including the inspection of bags. When my wife and I went to a Colorado Rockies baseball game a few weeks ago, we had to dump out the contents of our backpacks with our peanuts, transistor radio, and binoculars, which we've been carrying for five years. It was a hell of an inconvenience, the lines were long, but the people were pretty patient, because they understand the price. I would say that the changes in lifestyle will include armed guards at shopping malls, certainly at athletic events. The question then becomes, as professor Gaddis and I were discussing today, what about super-open institutions like universities? Everything is a target, and the more an institution like a great university prides itself on its openness, the more vulnerable it is. But do you want armed guards up and down the streets of New Haven? Students would go berserk. But the great challenge isn't a

**"Everything is a target, and the more an institution like a great university prides itself on its openness, the more vulnerable it is. But do you want armed guards up and down the streets of New Haven?"**

**"You have three new power centers in the world: terrorist organizations, mafias and drug cartels. When we get to the bottom of all this, we will find more links among these three entities in terms of money, weapons or information than we had previously expected."**

military challenge; it is a political-diplomatic challenge. To get to the roots of terrorism, as the military says, we need to dry up the swamp-money, weapons, shelter, and recruits, with recruits being the big issue. Barracks-life or training-camp life is a step up for these young men and boys in refugee camps. They get shelter, food, medicine, clothes, and they get a mission. It is a step up.

**YJP:** *You've mentioned the vulnerability of a nation of our size in protecting itself against a terrorist attack. Are we improving the human intelligence we need to predict other attacks, specifically those of a biological or chemical nature?*

**GH:** Clearly, since the 11th, I presume there has been a huge effort to beef up human intelligence, which will take years to accomplish. You need foreign language speakers; the best intelligence agents are in fact not Americans who learn to speak Arabic, but native Arabic speakers. Most espionage is not done by CIA employees, but by contract agents, or people they pay to get information. It's on that margin where we have really broken down. The critics of the agency reforms say they were crippled because they couldn't deal with "bad" people, but it is only "bad" people that know "bad" information. The reforms did not do that. Clinton did give an order that limited the kind of people that intelligence agents could deal with and how much money they could pay them. I would think this administration would probably lift a lot of those restrictions.

**YJP:** *How have these attacks and their consequences impacted the United States' role in the international community? How have we changed our views of governments we had nothing to do with in the past?*

**GH:** We are now faced with a new world in terms of both threats and opportunities. We have a chance to use this incident to reshape what we previously called the Western alliance or western coalition, to broaden it a great deal, particularly Russia and China. This serves as a tremendous opportunity to bring Russia into the West, which I think they wanted a lot more than we were willing to recognize or act on. China also has people operating in western China in what can be called a terrorist fashion; so they also have self-interests here. I think working with them could break down all kinds of political walls. Therefore, I see a tremendous opportunity here to reshape the western consensus. Saudi Arabia is important here. Iran is important here. Messages from countries like Syria and Iran that they sympathize are in some ways a bit shallow, but on the other hand unique. The more countries that we can get on our side, the better off we are. If Bush's goal can be accomplished of "smoking them out of their caves, rooting them out," then you have a chance to remake the world in that way.

Not that it'll ever be peace and harmony and no conflict. Nation-states will continue to disintegrate; there will continue to be culture clashes and struggles between ideologies and religions. I think poverty worldwide will never be eliminated, but we've got to do more than we have through the World Bank and the IMF. There is enough wealth in the West to help overcome that misery: not to eliminate all the poverty in the world. We haven't even eliminated it here in our country, with twenty percent of the children in this country in poverty. But this is an international problem. From an international relations point of view, this is a really historic time. The closest I can think would be the end of WWII, the period of 1945-8. You not only have this event, the elimination of the distinction between war and crime, but you also have globalization and the information revolution. This was not any ordinary time before September 11th, but now it's a truly extraordinary time.

**YJP:** *Could you elaborate on what you mean by the elimination of the distinction between war and crime?*

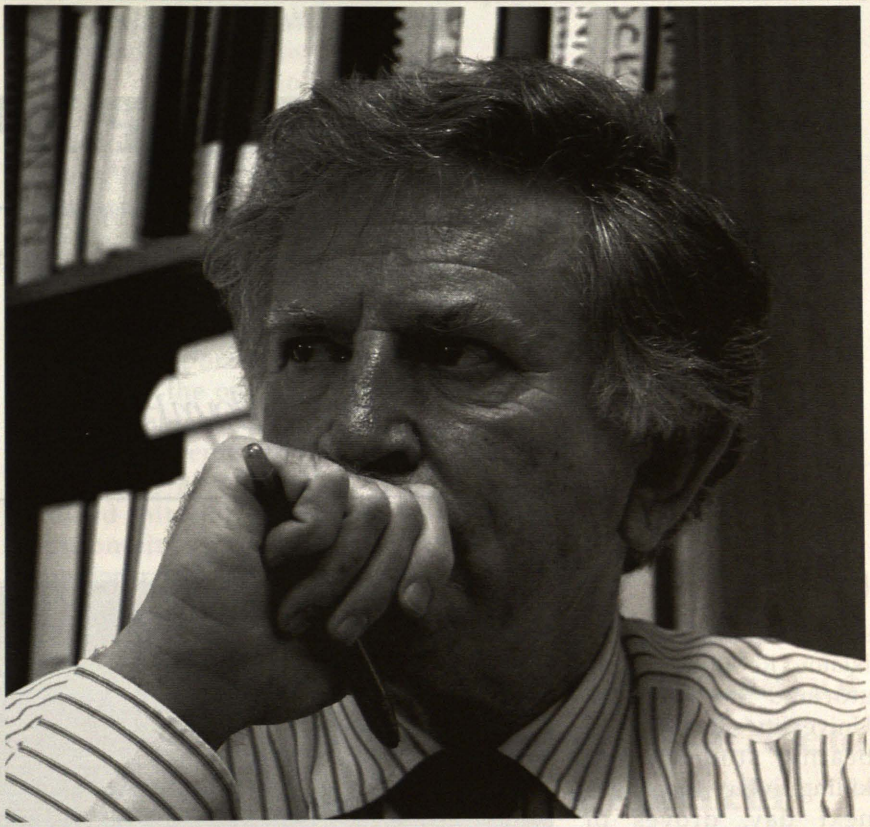
**GH:** War at the end of this century has occurred less often between nation-states as it essentially had been since been mid 17th century, and now consists of more low-intensity conflicts among tribes, clans and gangs. Of course the 90s proved this fairly right in that respect, whether Somalia, Haiti, Rwanda, with the one exception of the

Gulf War. And even that wasn't a traditional two-nation war. It was the last gasp of the nation-state wars, at least for the time being. I think the change began with the postcolonial wars at the end of WWII, where ethnic nationalism and regional nationalism overcame European colonialism. By the 70s, it evolved into guerilla warfare, as in Vietnam for the U.S. and for the Russians in Afghanistan. I think there was a direct link between guerrilla warfare and terrorism. Afghanistan is the perfect example; the people we trained to fight the guerrilla war are the terrorists attacking us.

If in New York City 7 or 70 people would have died, it would have been treated as a crime. Seven thousand is war. You can ask yourself where between seventy and seven thousand does crime become war. You have three new power centers in the world. One is terrorist organizations, networks that are more than just bin Laden. The other is mafias, more than just the Sicilians, that is the Russian and others. Then you have drug cartels. There are huge amounts of money circulating through those three overlapping power centers. When we get to the bottom of all this we will find more links among these three entities in terms of money, weapons, or information than we had previously expected.

**YJP:** *How does America as this beacon of hope that once welcomed, to quote the inscription on the Statue of Liberty, the world's "tired, poor, huddled masses yearning to breathe free," respond as it battles threats both within and outside our society?*

**GH:** We must take the opportunity here to reshape the international consensus; redefine what is permissible in a multi-ethnic, multi-national world; redefine the boundaries of behavior, of what is acceptable and what is not; get more nations on our side to rule that kind of behavior out; and then use that opportunity to form all kinds of diplomatic and political networks. We can not shut down our borders. We have a long way to go before we shut them down. Of all the vehicles and containers crossing our borders, we are inspecting 2%. Before September 11th,



Vincente Fox was here saying let the Mexican trucks across the border; you're holding them up too much. We're only inspecting 2%, so if we went to 25%, those trucks will be backed up for miles and days before they can even get to the inspection. Somewhere in there, a methodology has to be found. We will not change our Constitutional protections in my judgment. I do not think we will become a different kind of society, even if there is more than one attack. When you say how do we protect ourselves, I think there is no single simple answer. Essentially, what we are trying to do is find the culprits, root them out, and in the process we will have a fundamental reforming of our military structure. I think we certainly need to rethink what makes a nation secure on the lines of our commission's recommendations, not just protecting World Trade towers, but having enough funds and having high quality people in government.

*Gary Hart was a United States Senator who represented the State of Colorado from 1975 to 1987. He was a member of the Senate's Armed Services, Budget, and Intelligence Oversight Committees. Senator Hart holds a JD from Yale Law School.*

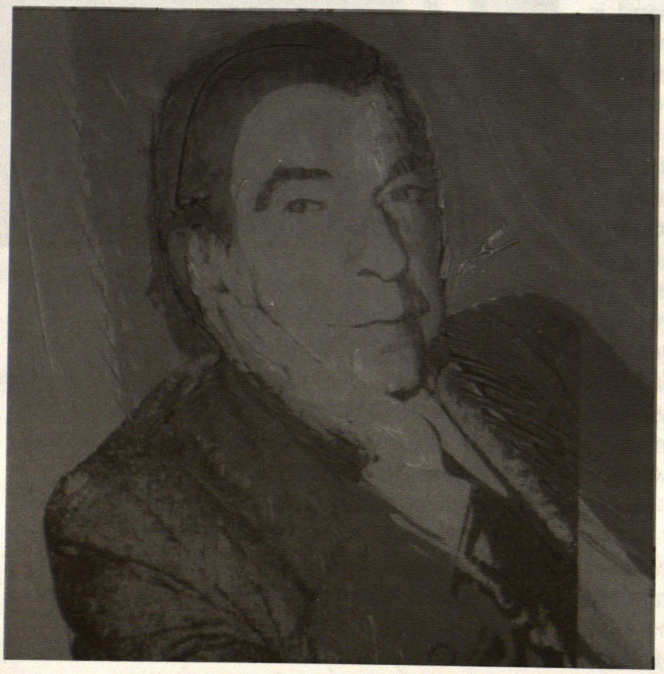
**"If Bush's goal can be accomplished of "smoking them out of their caves, rooting them out," then you have a chance to remake the world..."**

# THE GREAT LEAP BACKWARD

## THE TRAGIC HISTORY OF MODERN IRAN

*By Fereydoun Hoveyda*

On July 9, 1999, near midnight, the security forces of the Islamic Republic of Iran stormed Tehran University's dormitories, beating students and killing five of them. The next day, droves of students took to the streets and clashed with the police, the revolutionary guards, and other special security forces. For several days, the capital looked like a city under siege. Coming two years after the unexpected election of the "moderate" and "reformist" cleric Muhammed Khatami to the presidency, this telling event drew the world's attention to Iran once again. It confirmed that something was brewing under the sky of the totalitarian Islamic theocracy installed by Ayatollah Khomeini after the incredible flight of the Shah in January 1979. Baffled by the students' uprising (just as they were by the Islamic revolution), Western reporters and experts tried again to understand the new and unforeseen turns in Iranian politics.



An Andy Warhol portrait of Fereydoun Hoveyda

During the past 22 years many Middle East and Persian Gulf specialists have repeatedly analyzed the fall of the monarchy and the ascent of the clerics to power. But none, to my knowledge, has given a convincing account of the extraordinary conduct of the Iranian people who broke old chains only to forge new ones. Indeed, if their upheaval was directed against the repressive rule of the Shahs, why did they immediately submit to another tyranny? To find clues, experts dug into the soil of history in search for precedents. They compared, for instance, Tehran's events to the 1789 French Revolution, only to find out that the two had nothing in common: the French, like most revolutions, was future–oriented, while Khomeini's declared aim was to take the country back to the Middle Ages. And although the Iranians, like the French, overthrew an old monarchy, their Islamic Republic is certainly a far cry from the democratic ideals enshrined in the French constitution.

### The Iranian Mindset

A look at Iranian history shows that major events follow certain patterns described in ancient pre–Islamic and post–Islamic legends. But to understand the rule of either Khomeini or the Shah, it is imperative to concentrate on the particularities of the Iranian mindset and the deeply rooted beliefs that motivated them.

Iranian rulers have always been autocratic and, more often than not, very cruel—a rule to which Khomeini was no exception. They can be compared to harsh paternal figures with absolute authority over their "children." In a book published in 1978, Muhammad Reza Pahlavi called himself the "father, leader, and teacher of all Iranians." And Khomeini, while drinking (in his own words) the "poisoned chalice" of cease–fire after the eight–year–war with Iraq, proclaimed himself "ashamed" because of the many sacrifices imposed upon his people, and then added: "But then, is it not hard for *your old father?* "

In the Iranian tradition, a father is "indestructible" as long as he retains his position, no matter how weakened he may be by old age, illness or political factors. To be replaced, the father must die, abdicate, or flee the country. Moreover, Iranian "fathers" rule with an "iron fist" and do not hesitate to kill their own "sons" whenever necessary. To be sure, rulers sometimes wear kid gloves, but very rapidly they remove them and relish in complete absolutism. When this happens, the people grumble and lament the absence of a credible "father" to replace the tyrant, so they pray to God to send them a "savior" for whose arrival they wait with unlimited patience.

Curiously enough, this pattern continues to repeat itself with few variations. Thus, during the 20th century, several attempts at modernization took place in Iran. In the first years of the century, a group of educated Iranians, together with some high–ranking clerics, tribal chiefs, aristocrats, merchants, and city dwellers, revolted against the absolutism of the Shahs. Despite profound differences among the rebel factions, they succeeded in imposing a constitution on the monarchy. Obviously such a disparate alliance could not last long. The anarchy brewed by the constitutionalists' differences was compounded by foreign intrigues and occupation of parts of Iran during World War I, and resulted in the ascent of Reza Shah's authoritarian regime in 1925. Yet in his 15–year reign, Reza Shah brought basic modern institutions into existence with the help of young technocrats, intellectuals and nationalists. These included a Central Bank, a university, modern schools, hospitals, and regular police. A civil judiciary was even created as Islamic law was confined to purely religious matters. But World War II interrupted these efforts: once again, Iran became the battlefield of foreign interests. Thus, feudal landlords, tribal chieftains and clerics regained their lost powers. But because of the presence of the Allied troups who were waging a bloody war against totalitarianism, a kind of "experimental" democracy grew up in large cities like Tehran. With the end of the war and the withdrawal of troops, this experimental democracy faded away and the central government re–imposed its authority and erased the nascent freedoms of speech and association.

In the early 1950s, Muhammed Mossadegh's drive for nationalization of the oil industry briefly rekindled the elites' democratic dreams. But the coalition supporting him was as disparate as the one formed by the constitutionalists in the early years of the 20th century. Moreover, Mossadegh, an aristocrat and a landlord himself, was rather a traditionalist and opposed to revolutionary reforms. Regardless, he was toppled after three years in office by a CIA–SIS inspired *coup d'etat* that nipped the nationalist–reformist movement in the bud.

In the days of the Cold War, Washington, worried by Soviet expansionism, deemed it to be in its best interests to return the Shah to the throne and let him re–establish an authoritarian regime. But by the end of the 1950s, the new Kennedy administration in Washington felt that without basic changes, Iran would fall like a "ripe fruit" into the hands of the communists. So the White House pressured the Shah to name a new Prime Minister, Ali Amini, who started a vast land reform program. Suspicious of Amini, the monarch dismissed him at the first opportunity, and decided to undertake a comprehensive reform program himself. In this endeavor he felt he could not rely on the old political establishment and the traditional social classes whose interests would be hurt by some of the envisaged measures such as land reform, women's equality, secular judiciary, and modern banking. Thus, the Shah decided to co–opt the younger generation of technicians (mostly offsprings of the establishment and rich bazaar merchants) trained in Europe and America.

A number of "nationalists" who had been close supporters of Mossadegh rejected any kind of cooperation with the Shah. But the "realists" argued that given the Cold War and the growing influence of the United States, the only way of bringing Iran into modernity

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was to work from inside the regime on the basis of a reasoned cooperation with the Shah. The Kennedy and the Johnson administrations seemed to be committed to deep reforms. This presented Iran a unique opportunity: the cooperation with the Shah did not signify a blanket approval of his policies, but a kind of unwritten contract limited to the definite goal of economic development and modernization of society. Indeed, the liberals thought that a modern economic infrastructure would bring about desired changes in the social superstructure and pave the way toward democracy.

In brief, the young technocrats took over the economic and educational parts of the government, leaving the political and military affairs in the Shah's hands. As a result, in less than fifteen years they were able to build up a solid economic and communications infrastructure. Thus, in hindsight, it could be said that, if the Islamic Republic created by Khomeini had not stopped the implementation of the Point Four plan which had just begun in mid–1978, Iran may well rank now among a group of economically advanced countries such as South Korea, Taiwan, or even Belgium.

## On the Brim of Disaster

Despite these reforms, things were far from satisfactory in the late 1970s. Inflation was running high because of the exceedingly rapid economic growth, caused particularly by the sudden rise in oil prices. Corruption was spreading at the higher crusts of society, especially in the royal family and in its entourage. Censorship and secret police actions were indisposing intellectuals, journalists and members of the growing middle–class. The religious establishment was worried about losing its financial assets and political clout; it was also appalled by the disaffection of youngsters from religion. Bazaar merchants were growling against modern financial institutions that were gnawing at their former quasi–monopoly of financial and commercial activities. As the Shah steadily grew more authoritarian and conceited, "technocrats" lost their hopes of the early 1960s. There were many voices critical of the situation, but none suggested the imminent upheaval that brought the most reactionary segment of the religious establishment to power in less than a year.

As it appears now, Khomeini's *Velayat–e–faghih* ("tutelage of the theologian–jurisprudent") which invests final decisions in the person of the "Supreme Religious Guide of the Revolution," constitutes a great leap *backward*. An old–type tyrannical system has been re–imposed on an entire country and its people. According to internal opponents and most external observers, Iran is now on the brim of disaster. Human rights violations and brutal repression have reached levels never before seen. The economy is in shambles, inflation and unemployment have reached astronomic figures, and corruption festers at every level of the social scale.

How has such a catastrophe been possible? Why, for the third or fourth time in the 20th century, have the "reformers" and the "liberals" stumbled? The causes of this sad state of affairs are numerous. Some pertain to internal and international circumstances; others result from economic mistakes or Iranian character and tradition. Looking back, it seems that Iranian reformers constantly ignored the fact that their nation was not in the 20th century but rather steeped in the Middle Ages. The technocrats of the 1960s, like their predecessors of the 1900s, the 1930s, and the 1950s, were themselves still lugging along many traditional beliefs that were in direct contradiction with modernization. In a very short period of time, without trying to prepare the masses to the ongoing world scientific and technological revolution, they introduced a cascade of novelties: electricity, automobiles, planes, automated factories, mechanized agriculture, radio, cinema, television, and medical drugs. To the people at large, the rapid modernization seemed somehow magical and, to the devout, rather satanic.

The shock of modernization became disturbing. To be sure, the technocrats did not ignore the possibility of a cultural boomerang, but in their haste to bring Iran into the 20th century, they remained over–confident in the ability of Western methods. To be fair, some among them warned the Shah; however, the monarch dismissed their worries. Curiously enough, he himself acted rather contrarily: he favored at the same time modernization and traditional values, pushing full–steam economic and social transformation while solidly clinging to the old–Iranian concept of "absolute" monarchy! His was a profoundly ancestral and paternalistic view of governance.

I have mentioned above the Iranian "father–ruler" notion. I submit that the three generations of young educated Iranians of the 20th century could not survive without finding a "father" to follow and eventually submit to. In the 1920s, they joined the strong man Reza Khan who soon became a brutal Shah. In the 1950s, Mossadegh became their hero and in the 1960s and 1970s a majority of the young technocrats cooperated with the monarch. This "father syndrome" constitutes at least one of the reasons for the repeated failures of Iranian reformers. At any rate, the 1960s reformers rapidly lost sight of their democratic goals and became the "children" of the "father–ruler." Infighting among the rulers diminished the power of their movement and became a weapon in the hands of all the enemies of modernization and democracy.

Viewing Iran's experience during the 20th century in retrospect, it seems that only a continuing open public debate on reforms, with the participation of intellectuals and private groups, might eventually overcome the formidable obstacle of obsolete traditions and old habits. One lesson of the failures of Iran's 20th century modernizers is obviously that one cannot change society from above. One cannot reform by issuing edicts. People themselves must be convinced of the necessity of deep changes.

## Basic Freedoms and Economic Development

Iran's problems demonstrate that modernization and development are not only a question of economic and material improvement, but also a problem of mindset. Reading recently the new book by the Nobel-Prize-winning economist Amartya Sen, I was impressed by his concept of development as "a process of expanding the real freedom that people enjoy." He explains that "respect for people's human and civil rights is a central part of their development" because there are no markets in which the satisfaction of such rights can be bought. Human rights, he underlines, matter in economic development because the exercise of all other capabilities depends on not being subject to arrest, imprisonment, torture, or execution.

Sen's contention brings me to the present situation in Iran. The goals of the active student movement are not fundamentally different from those of the three generations of modernizers that preceded them. Indeed, they share the goal of bringing Iran into modern times. As Gholam-Reza Mohajeri-Nejad, one of the architects of the student movement, recently said in an interview, 20 million Iranians voted for Khatami in order "to achieve real freedom and a secular form of government, to hold a referendum and create a constitution that embraces everyone, where the individual and social rights of the people are respected." Referring to President Khatami's idea of "religious democracy," he added: "Iran is not an Arab country. We have a different heritage that is neither Islamic nor religious. We are not like Arab countries; our culture and people are different. Such an Islamic democratic state might work in other Middle Eastern countries but not in our country. And there are those in the West that are proponents of these ideas. We are totally against such ideas." He concluded: "Our society is more than ever ready to enter the 21st century and I believe that, with individual freedom, we will achieve the goals we have set forth."

*Fereydoun Hoveyda is a former Iranian Ambassador to the United Nations. He authored, among other books,* The Fall of the Shah, *an important documentation of modern Iranian political history.*

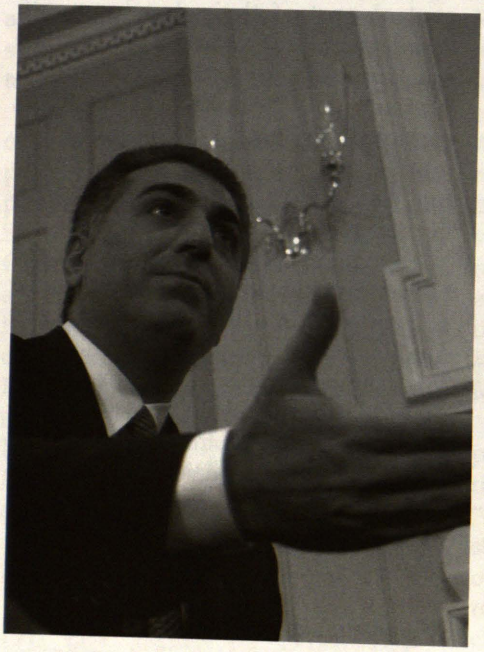
**"Viewing Iran's experience during the 20th century in retrospect, it seems that only a continuing open public debate on reforms, with the participation of intellectuals and private groups, might eventually overcome the formidable obstacle of obsolete traditions and old habits."**

# HIS IMPERIAL MAJESTY REZA PAHLAVI

## IRAN IN EXILE: THE QUEST FOR DEMOCRACY

### AN INTERVIEW

*His Imperial Majesty Reza Pahlavi is no stranger to militant Islamic theocracies like the Taliban. In 1979, his father, the late Shah of Iran, was forced to abdicate the Iranian throne and flee his homeland after Ayatollah Ruhollah Khomeini led an Islamic revolution that has brought decades of strict clerical rule to Iran. Reza Pahlavi was only seventeen when he was forced to flee his country with his father and the rest of the royal family. He then went to Williams College and spent some time living in Egypt and Morocco afterwards. Next, he moved to Northern Virginia where he has lived for the past seventeen years.*



*From his home in Washington D.C., Mr. Pahlavi has been traveling the country advocating for non-violent change in his country. Utilizing his Internet site, rezapahlavi.com, and his contacts in Iran, Reza Pahlavi is building support for his movement of secular rule in Iran. While the heir to the Iranian throne would not be opposed to retaking the throne under a constitutional monarchy, he insists that he is merely acting as a catalyst so that the Iranian people can choose their government for themselves. Regardless, in the wake of the tragic September 11th terrorist attacks, Mr. Pahlavi has been making the rounds on television news programs insisting that a regime change in the Middle East's most strategically important country would bring change and stability to the rest of the region. With growing opposition within Iran to the current clerical regime, Reza Pahlavi believes that this change can become a reality in the very near future. The Politic recently sat down with His Imperial Majesty and asked him some questions about his life, his movement, and the future:*

Interview conducted 10/29/01

**Yale's Journal of Politics:** *It seems that many Iranians have taken the recent turmoil in the Middle East as an opportunity to express their frustrations at the strict Islamic religious government. Thousands have taken to the streets, while the conservative authorities have tried to crack down on public dissent. How will the events of the last few weeks and their consequences impact the next chapter of Iranian history?*

**H.I.M. Reza Pahlavi:** Today we clearly have a very explosive situation in Iran, despite the campaign promises of Mr. Muhammed Khatami, which have not materialized over the last five years. We have already heard people in Iran shouting "Beyond Khatami" and asking for referendum and reform and secularism. What happened on September 11th has caused refocused attention on that part of the world, which in turn has given the people under that regime a new sense of opportunity and hope. In that context, what Iranians today are more vehemently voicing is a loss of fear, clearly demonstrated by the fact that young people are willing to risk life and limb to send their messages out to the world. The current campaign in Afghanistan against the Taliban is clearly presenting an opportunity in the sense that if there were a democratic outcome in Afghanistan, certainly a country like Iran and all people would see this as a favorable precedent as to what could happen with the process of democratization of not only one country but of an entire area.

**YJP:** *Fifty million of Iran's seventy million people are under 30 years old. Does this figure make a regime change in Iran almost inevitable?*

**H.I.M.:** I don't think it is so much a question of age as much as it is the conclusion of a society that has had to face theocracy for the last 23 years. We can clearly see that at some point there must be a recognition of the incompatibility of theocracy and democracy. The bottom line is that Iran has a regime in place that has sustained itself on the grounds of divine rule based on the interpretation of a Supreme Leader, and that can not in any way address the needs of a society that is aspiring for political representation and economic opportunity. So the direct result of living under a theocracy has created the misery and unemployment we see today, and

a situation where, at the slightest case of protest, people are basically accused of betraying God and are subject to execution. Even parliamentary members under this system are thrown in jail. The solution can only come through a secular democracy that allows Iranians to benefit from what they are aspiring to achieve.

The young generation of today is the first line of advocacy of the need for change beyond this theocracy. It is, in a way, a breath of fresh air when we see a young generation that is focused on the future. These are the so-called children and grandchildren of the Revolution. But today, when they look to the opportunities of the future and Iran's place in the world, they understand its potential if we succeed in our campaign of restoring freedom and self-determination to our homeland. They are the most vocal because they are the ones who stand to benefit from that change the most. What they don't have today, they could have under a new system tomorrow. It is only natural that the first voice that speaks out belongs to that generation.

In most of the political movements that have struck a nerve in any country throughout history, the youth factor was first. The intellectual demand for change usually begins on university campuses around the world. It is only natural that the same rule applies in Iran. Two years ago, it was the initial youth movement that began questioning whether these promises of reform were being translated into action. Today, people are no longer questioning whether this system can revise itself or whether certain laws can be changed; rather, the theocracy itself is the problem. We thus need to bring back a secular system in the context of a separation of clergy from the state. This is the bottom line conclusion that is being discussed in Iran today.

**YJP:** *What roles do the United States, Europe, and the international community in general play in facilitating this movement towards a secular democracy?*

**H.I.M.:** I think there are two parallel courses that have to be taken. What the focus must be vis-a-vis the current regime and the one that follows is what to do vis-a-vis the people of Iran. In simple terms, the signal that has to be sent to the people of Iran is that a country like the United States stands on its own professed principle of supporting democratization and democracy anywhere and at all times. In this case, the U.S. must declare that it stands with the people of Iran in their struggle for self-determination and democracy. That message is basically moral support. It can be followed by specific actions that prove the honesty of these statements. For example, the U.S. should not cut deals with the existing clerical regime, it should not provide the regime with opportunities to maintain its power, it should cut its economic lifeline, and it should put pressure on Iran in terms of political reforms and human rights violations.

A case in point is Iran's goal of joining the WTO. The world can say to Iran that it still has terrorist camps, it still finances extremist groups in the Middle East, it still antagonizes the peace process, it still pursues weapons of mass destruction, and its conduct in terms of human rights can not be accepted or condoned. There must be a precondition for acceptance linked to a performance-based reaction to the system.

The most important element here is the issue of human rights, including the freedom of political prisoners, the reversal of the ban on the media, and the freedom of political parties to form and assemble. These are the kinds of tangibles the people in Iran are going to scrutinize. If a commitment is made beyond words in actual deeds, the balance will tip in favor of the people of Iran, to the detriment of the regime.

**YJP:** *To what extent does the current Iranian regime misrepresent to the international community the feelings of most Iranian citizens? Does the American media misrepresent the feelings of most Middle Easterners by repeatedly showing images of anti-West protesters?*

**H.I.M.:** One of the ways that regimes stay in power is by orchestrating a theatrical display of statements that come across as if they are representative of what the people of that nation have to say. Examples include what the Krem-

**"The world can say to Iran that it still has terrorist camps, it still finances extremist groups in the Middle East, it still antagonizes the peace process, it still pursues weapons of mass destruction, and its conduct in terms of human rights can not be accepted or condoned."**

lin was doing during the Cold War or what the regime in Iran does every Friday prayer with chants of "Death to America, Death to Israel." These are clearly aimed at projecting an image that would be read as if it were popular sentiment.

Interestingly, the world does not ask if there is an alternate viewpoint, and if there were, where and how could we possibly hear it, especially in today's Iran. There is supposedly a ban on the media under a reformist regime. There is not a single political party that can participate in the process. There are not real elections in Iran. We all know that, but the world continues to talk about Khatami and his 70% vote return. Who else would have been fielded as a legitimate candidate to the people without going through that filtering process? People keep forgetting that Mr. Khatami is not there to change the system; he is there to preserve it and prolong its life. His loyalty is to a constitution that today enables those in authority to throw legislators into jail for questioning the constitution itself.

When the world is not privy to these issues, when the media does not focus on them, and when all they see are certain images on the street, you can understand how easy it could be for people to misconstrue the phenomenon. Take the example of Pakistan today. We have recently seen very many anti-American demonstrations. These protests are mostly due to economic malaise in Pakistan proper, which is the backdrop for radicals there to provoke these protests. I wonder how much the protests actually have to do with bin Laden and the situation in next-door Afghanistan. It's a manipulation tactic that has always been used by these warmongers.

As far as Iran is concerned, we are lucky that these recent post-soccer riots that have turned into anti-regime protests have been reported in the media. There were many before them that were never reported. The local correspondents of *The Financial Times* or *The Wall Street Journal* can no longer pretend that they are not occurring. When they see kids on the streets being brutally beaten by the regime elements or when they hear students chant "Death to Khomeini," they can no longer pretend that these are isolated incidents. Hundreds of thousands of people are speaking up. It is very similar to what we saw in Iran in 1978. The world will take notice of it when the media talks about it and when international governments revise their policies towards Iran.

What can accentuate that notice are, of course, Iranians around the world. The Iranian Diaspora, in particular, has a key role to play. I feel that we can certainly put more pressure on the government in this country to conduct more hearings, to bring people from directly inside Iran to testify as to what is really happening there, and to better inform and educate the legislators. This awareness will ultimately translate into a reshaping of foreign policy, aimed at provoking a departure from the status quo and the containment/appeasement duality approach they have taken with this regime.

The biggest setback we have had all these years has been the obsession to pursue moderates within the regime, an illusion that was created and furthered by the Khatami gang, who realized that as long as Americans are willing to believe there is a "good cop, bad cop" scenario, they will appease the regime. However, after four elections, why has the "good cop" failed to implement one of his campaign promises, at a time when Iran clearly needs foreign investment and wants political reform? The root problem is the regime itself and its inherent nature, which is unable to undergo change. If Iran were to change for the better, the whole process of stability and democratization could begin to occur throughout the Middle East, since Iran is the pivotal country in this region.

**YJP**: *How do you foresee the development of this movement towards change? If there is a call for your return to Iran as the figurehead of a secular democratic state, will you answer that call?*

**H.I.M.:** The ideal scenario, brought about by non-violent change, centers on the need for a national referendum with international observers, so the Iranian people can determine the future of their country and the type of government they would like to have. I consider my role to be one of a catalyst who can unite all Iranians around two common goals: the need for self-determination and a secular democracy. This is the role I have set for myself. Frankly, I consider it my mission in life to ultimately witness people going to the polls for a national referendum. What happens afterwards is secondary. As for my returning to Iran, I stand willing to serve my country in whatever capacity it wishes for me.

# JOHN GADDIS

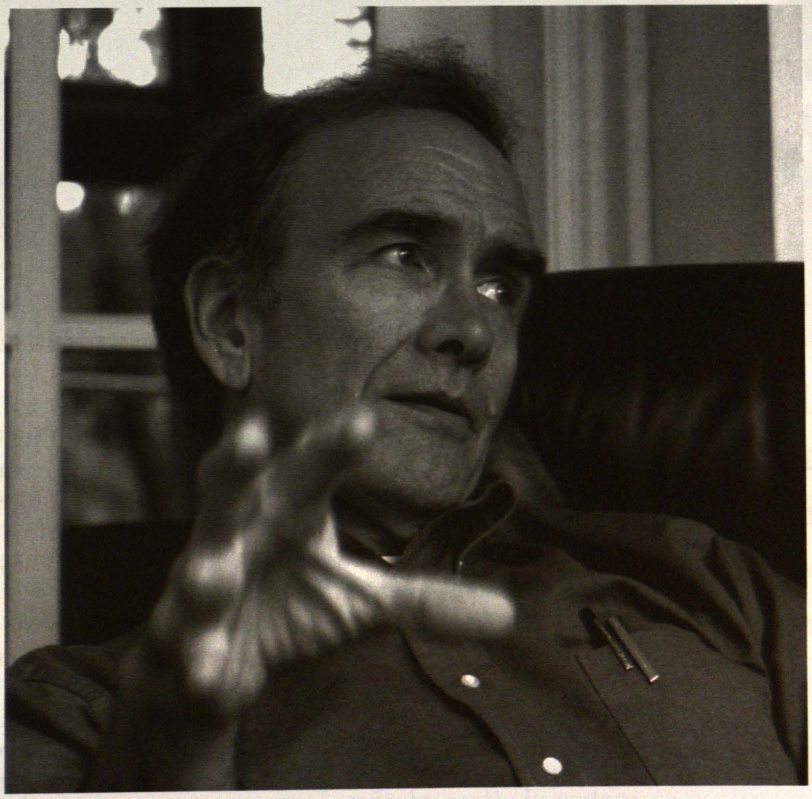
## THE COLD WAR AND THE NEW WAR

### AN INTERVIEW

Interview conducted 9/28/01

**Yale's Journal of Politics:** *Professor Gaddis, in what ways does our current conflict find its roots in Cold War policy?*

**John Gaddis:** During World War II, and on into the Cold War, we began to conceive of the term "national security" as it related to international threats. The assumption was that the threat was external, that it was from the Soviet Union, or the Chinese, for example. The idea that somehow threats to the national security could develop from within simply did not arise. It is true the hijackers were from without, but the instruments they used were familiar objects that we are used to as normal aspects of everyday life. To some extent, our Cold War mentality of thinking about national security only as an international threat caused us to be blind to the kinds of threats that could arise in this way.



**YJP:** New York Times *columnist Thomas Friedman claimed that the problems that led to the terrorist attack were not a lack of intelligence but a lack of imagination. To what degree do you think the complacency of the CIA, the NSA or the FBI contributed to this attack?*

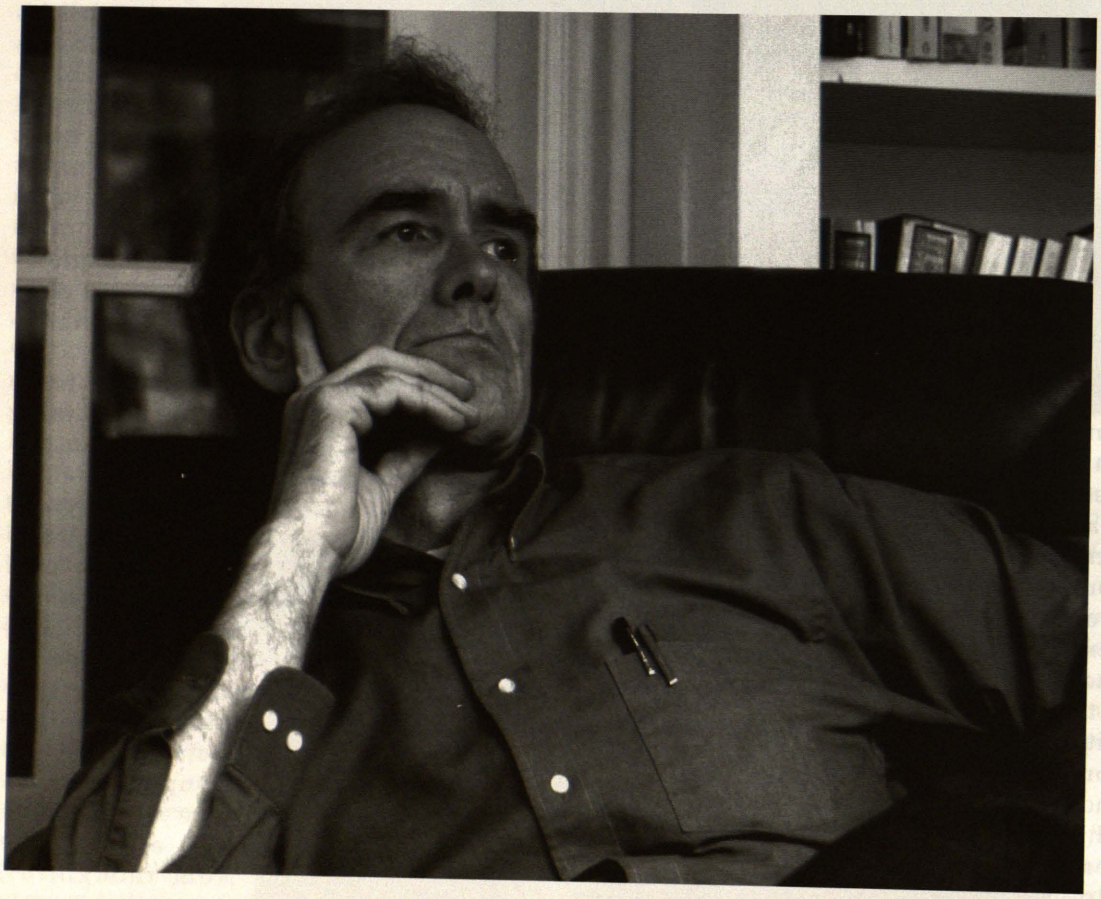
**JG:** Obviously this was an intelligence failure of the same scale as Pearl Harbor. In defense of the intelligence agencies, the small size of this group as compared to the massive military operation of Pearl Harbor made it somewhat harder to anticipate.

Failure of imagination, yes, although the tense thing about this is that some people *were* thinking about this possibility: notably, the Hart-Rudman Report was right on target with its estimate. That report, which came out in March of this year, was correct in identifying our vulnerabilities, and the need to redefine national security to take them into account. So it's not as though there was no warning; there was, and it came from thoughtful, imaginative people in this country.

**YJP:** Is it fair to denounce the CIA and other intelligence organizations for not anticipating an event like this when they do very often avert similar situations?

**JG:** Yes, it is fair, because they did *not* avert this one, and the consequences were disastrous. The real test in asking a question like that is then to ask the next question, which is, if you're not prepared to hold someone responsible for failing to anticipate this event, are you then saying that you would change nothing in the future as to how we think about threats? Nobody is saying that. Nobody

claims that the United States is to blame for the Japanese attack on Pearl Harbor. But on the other hand, nobody would say that the United States should have continued the same policies after the Japanese attack as if it had not happened.



**YJP:** *What intelligence changes do you anticipate as a result of these attacks?*

**JG:** I think there's going to be a lot more emphasis on identifying and eradicating the sources of terrorism; intelligence agencies have not been totally focused on groups like that in the past. I believe that the division between foreign and domestic intelligence operations is going to be a lot fuzzier as a result of this. The relationship between the CIA and the FBI has not always been great. That again is an artifact of Cold War thinking: the idea is that the CIA is responsible for overseas affairs, and the FBI is responsible for domestic affairs. I think there's going to have to be a lot more cooperation between the agencies.

I also think we may well see more surveillance. We'll just get used to seeing security cameras every block along city streets.

**YJP:** *Do you think there will be much resistance from civil rights advocates in response to measures like that which you mention?*

**JG:** The resistance is already shaping up, and it's quite interesting in that it comes from both the right and the left. From the left, there are concerns about civil liberties; from the right, there are worries about guns, gun control, and gun ownership. But I think this was a horrendous enough event that things are not just going to continue as they were. Where the line is going to be drawn, where the resistance becomes so great that you can no longer implement a significant amount of policy change, I really can't say.

**YJP:** *How do nuclear weapons fit into a terrorist context?*

**JG:** I'm not sure that's the most cost-effective approach for a terrorist to take, because it requires a major industrial facility operation to produce a nuclear weapon, and it's hard to do that without attracting attention. It seems to me that if you want to kill a lot of people, as was demonstrated in this attack, there are other ways to do it that *are* very cost-effective. One of the things that

is really quite astonishing about this is how cost-effective it was, how few people were able to do so much damage.

For us, the fear is that our nuclear weapons are of absolutely no use in this type of situation. Obviously, a nuclear weapon, if a terrorist should get hold of one, would be highly relevant. The question is, how would we retaliate? The main goal now should be to try to convince those states that have nuclear weapons to prevent proliferation to states and particularly to groups that want them. But it is all the more tricky, of course, because now both the Indians and the Pakistanis possess nuclear capability.

**YJP:** *Before September 11th, there was a lot of opposition to Bush's* plan *to strengthen national missile defense. It seems like this resistance has evaporated since the attacks. What happened to that opposition?*

**JG:** Part of what has happened to it is simply patriotism: you don't criticize the President under these circumstances. I think this event has probably reinforced the case for national missile defense, in the sense that it demonstrates how vulnerable we are to rogue states or rogue groups. I think the real issue is going to be the position that the Hart-Rudman Commission took on this: that missile defense is something we should be investigating.

But they also said that is only a small part of the problem. I think we'll go ahead with missile defense, but I don't think it will be the main thing the administration focuses on to the extent that it was before September 11th; I think it will be part of a larger package.

**YJP:** *Would you be concerned about the consequences of a covert effort to overthrow the Taliban?*

**JG:** I think we will see more toleration of this sort of thing, because we have fallen into the habit over the last ten or fifteen years of defining our allies in terms of justice, in terms of people who have the same standards as the United States with regard to human rights. And now we're going to swing back to something we did in the Cold War, which was to define our allies not according to ideals but according to interest. We will be willing to tolerate cooperation with some unsavory regimes in order to deal with this threat. The current regime in Pakistan, which came to power as a result of a military coup and is certainly no democracy, could help us deal with a group of people who killed 7000 American citizens on American soil, which was surely a great injustice. But how do you weigh these two injustices: that of coming to power by way of a military coup in Pakistan, and that which happened in this country on September 11th. I think that's a tough one, and I think that the answer is pretty clear: you tend to look for friends where you can get them, and it won't be the first time that's happened.

**YJP:** *Recently, Israel has undertaken a strategic program of political assassination to eliminate and to intimidate the opposition leadership. Do you foresee the American government using this option in its war on terrorism, and do you think the American people, if they were to know about it, would accept it?*

**JG:** Yes.

**YJP:** *The International Community has criticized Israel for its assasination program; you don't think that there will be similar criticism of the United States?*

**JG:** I think that criticism will change in some ways. It's a very dicey business, and there are a couple of things you have to think about if you are considering this option: first, is the target someone who really is so dangerous that larger interests are going to be served by getting rid of him? If somebody should bump off bin Laden in the next fifteen minutes or so, I don't think you'd find many objections from anybody. But suppose you bump off somebody who only

**"We have fallen into the habit of defining our allies in terms of justice, in terms of people who have the same standards as the United States with regard to human rights, for example. And now we're going to swing back to something we did in the Cold War, which was to define our allies not according to ideals, but according to interest."**

**"This attack could have happened to the Egyptians, it could have happened to the Iranians, or it could have happened to the Russians. Any disaffected group that wants to take a couple of airliners, hijack them and fly them into some national capital is something that grabs the attention of every organized state."**

has tenuous ties to bin Laden, or who you think has ties to bin Laden but who proves not to have ties. Or you turn somebody into a martyr by doing this; that's a real risk with bin Laden. Sometimes these people have more power in death than they do in life.

The other problem with assassination is that it can go both ways: it can come back to haunt you. I'm not saying that it takes our effort to bump off some foreign leader to cause somebody else that to think that he then has license to retaliate, but I do think that bumping off some foreign leader probably does make the security dilemmas of our own people more relevant. In that sense, I think it's very much a double-edged sword.

It becomes problematic when it is used as it was during the Cold War: to get rid of people who are not particularly dangerous, but who simply won't take our orders. That's where we begin to get a backlash, and is something the U.S. has to be very careful about.

**YJP:** *Do you envision our new allies in the Middle East (particularly Jordan, Syria, Iran and Pakistan) supporting a sustained invasion of Afghanistan?*

**JG:** I think that merely going into Afghanistan and cleaning things out would not end the terrorist threat because these terrorists are part of larger networks. What will end Middle East support is the full implementation of what's already being called the "Bush Doctrine," which is the notion that any state that supports terrorism, either covertly or tacitly, is complicit in terrorism.

What is new about this threat is the sense of common danger that it evokes. This attack could have happened to the Egyptians, it could have happened to the Iranians, or it could have happened to the Russians. Any disaffected group that wants to take a couple of airliners, hijack them and fly them into some national capital is something that grabs the attention of every organized state.

What is happening is a kind of dramatization of something that we have been loosely talking about for a long time: the decline of states in the face of economic integration and globalization, and the decline of states as a consequence of political self-determination, as in the case of the Soviet Union.

Now there is a third threat to states, which is the power of international terrorism acting against states. At the beginning of the Cold War, the Russians and the Americans were so badly divided that there simply was no common interest at all. What created a common interest was the mutual realization of the danger of nuclear weapons to both sides, and eventually the realization of that danger cooled the Cold War. It could be that this terrorist threat could have the same effect in overcoming a lot of other differences, if all states begin to perceive this as a threat not just against Americans but as a threat to all states.

**YJP:** *Do you see an increased return to isolationist sentiments in the Unites States after these attacks?*

**JG:** I think it will make us isolationist in one sense, by debunking the old assumption that people and goods can simply move freely across international borders without distinction. This has been one of the basic principles of globalization. It's going to be harder to trade, it's going to be harder to travel, it's going to harder to migrate as a result of this crisis, because what this has shown us is that these things like free movement of people and goods, which we automatically consider to be a good thing, can also be a dangerous thing.

*John Gaddis is the Robert A. Lovett Professor of Military and Naval History at Yale University. He has authored several books, including* We Now Know, *a classic and influential publication on the Cold War.*

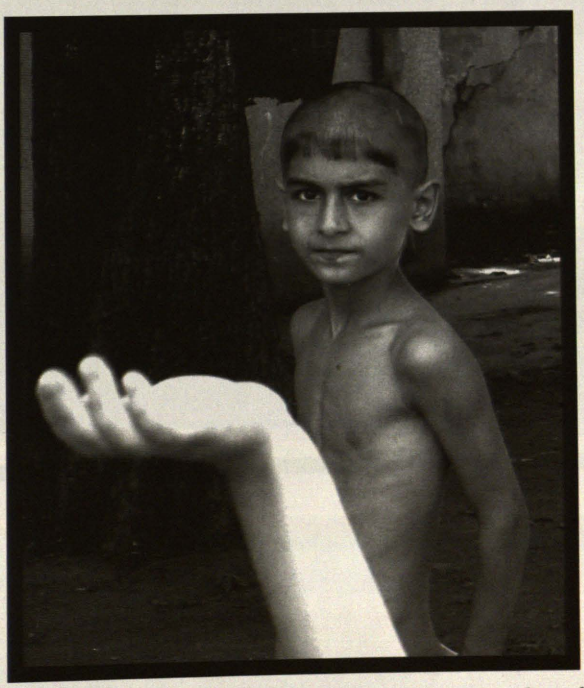
# INCURABLES

## THE PLIGHT OF ROMANIA'S ORPHANS: A PHOTO ESSAY

*By Peter J. van Agtmael*

*In 1966, Nicolae Ceausescu, then dictator of Romania, enacted a law prohibiting abortion for women under forty with fewer than four children. He introduced compulsory monthly medical checkups for all women of childbearing-age to ensure that they weren't having abortions. Most families were unable to cope with the burden of so many children, and were consequently forced to abandon them in state-run orphanages. When Ceaucescu was executed in 1989, the first images of Romania's orphanages filtered to the west. The scenes they presented were akin to the worst photos of concentration camps in Nazi Germany. A deluge of media attention followed. The force of these images sparked a huge influx of foreign volunteers, all eager to reform the system.*

*Ten years later, the media attention has largely died out, but many of the same problems remain. According to The Economist's 2000 "quality of life" survey, the living standard in Romania ranks somewhere between Libya and Lebanon. Unsurprisingly, this means few advances in the field of childcare. Some of the orphanages haven't improved at all. Many have improved aesthetically, providing fodder for government propaganda about their children's rights record. Most of the volunteer organizations have left or run out of money. The overwhelming attention of the early 90's fueled international adoption, and corrupted it entirely. In a nation where the average monthly salary is $80, the baby trade is a way of living grandly. The new government of Adrian Nastase has declared that they are committed to reform, but like everything in Romania, only time will tell.*



The stink was what got me the most. Feces and urine and vomit and un-bathed bodies. It's an abstract smell to most, imaginable, but not fathomable. It's a sickly amalgamation of the thousands of children that had passed through the rooms. Many of them dead, some on the streets, some still tied to rotting, rusting cribs. It is a humid, wet smell and an enveloping one. A smell so sick I felt like I could see it, like I could touch it only it would burn me. I couldn't escape it by breathing fresh air out of an open window. I couldn't escape it by leaving, by getting into a car or a train. By traveling five miles or five thousand. I can't escape it three months after I last smelled it and I don't know if I ever will.

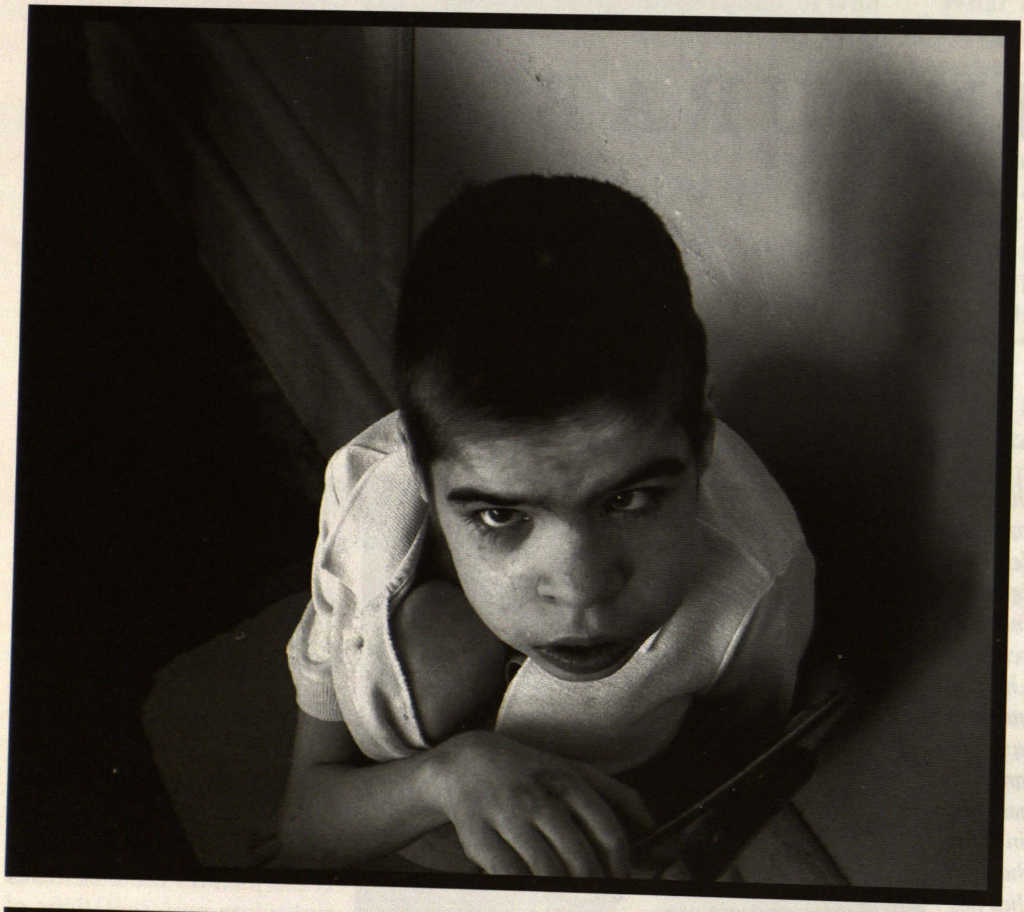
The smell is something you can't see in these pictures and won't see in these pictures. These pictures are only black and white representations of nothing. Just snapshots of moments, single moments mostly taken at 1/60 of a second at f/2. They are colorless pictures of color, and they are whole lives captured in instants.

These pictures try, they really do. But there is a lot of despair, a lot of misery, a lot of horror that ended a second too soon to focus the camera or change the aperture. There are sounds, like screams that grab your ear and won't let go and piercing howls that sounds like animals but are really children, five, ten, fifteen years old. None of that can be captured on a negative.

These are pictures you see but there are hundreds that you don't. There are hundred of photos of children and infants that are suffering anonymously but suffering anyways. They are on my computer, or collecting dust in a flimsy negative carrier. They are in my mind, inescapably. There are fifteen, maybe twenty faces in these photos, but there are a thousand that I saw that aren't here.

These photos are depressing but they ultimately fail you. Look at them and try to envision suffering a thousand times worse. Impossible? It is impossible. It's the limitation of photography. It's also one of the ironies of human nature. No matter how hard we try to understand something through words or photos, we never really can. Only the witness can truly understand the horror.

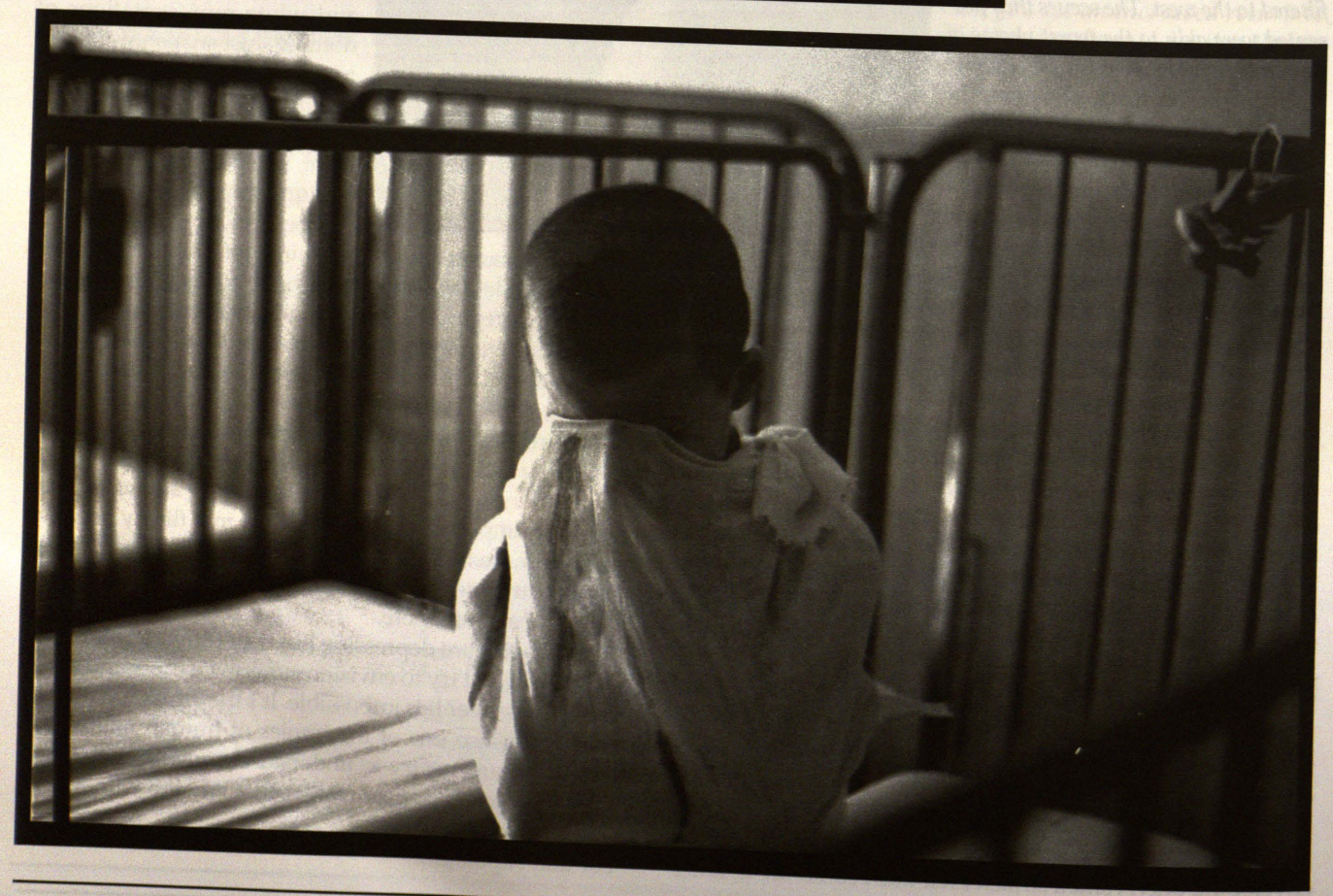
For that I apologize.



**Previous page:** There are thousands of children living on the streets of Bucharest, the capital. The older ones were thrown out of the orphanages when they turned eighteen. Most of the rest simply ran away. They live in the sewers or in the parks, and steal or beg to eat. Many of them forget reality with the cheap fix that huffing toxic glue provides.

**Left:** Most of the children in the Camin Spital's spend their days curled up in a fetal position, fearfully watching all who pass.

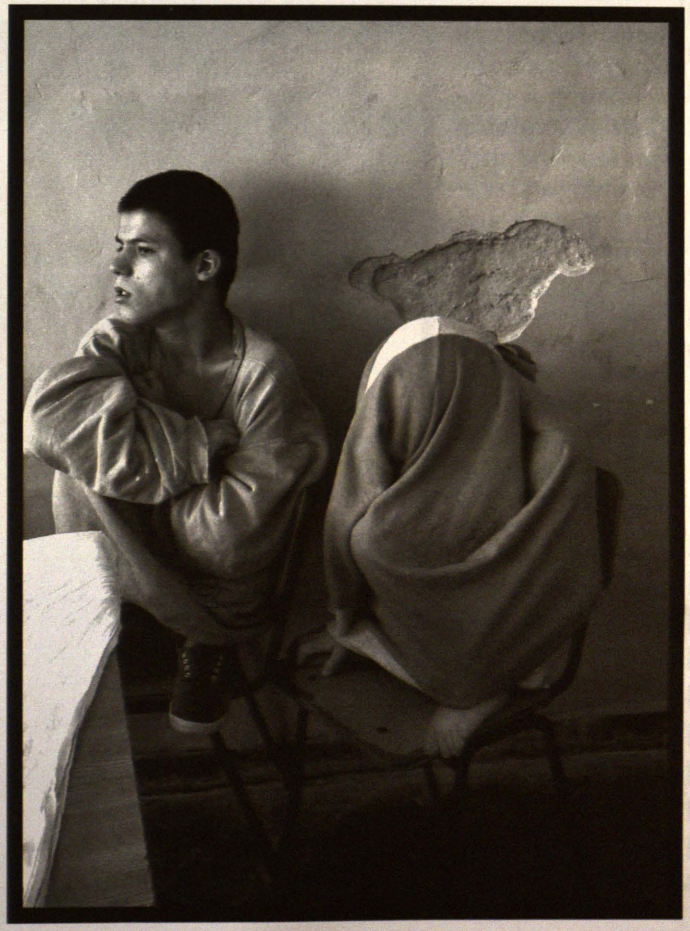
**Below:** In order to prevent mischief or violence, many children are tied in primitive strait jackets or to their beds for days or even weeks at a time.

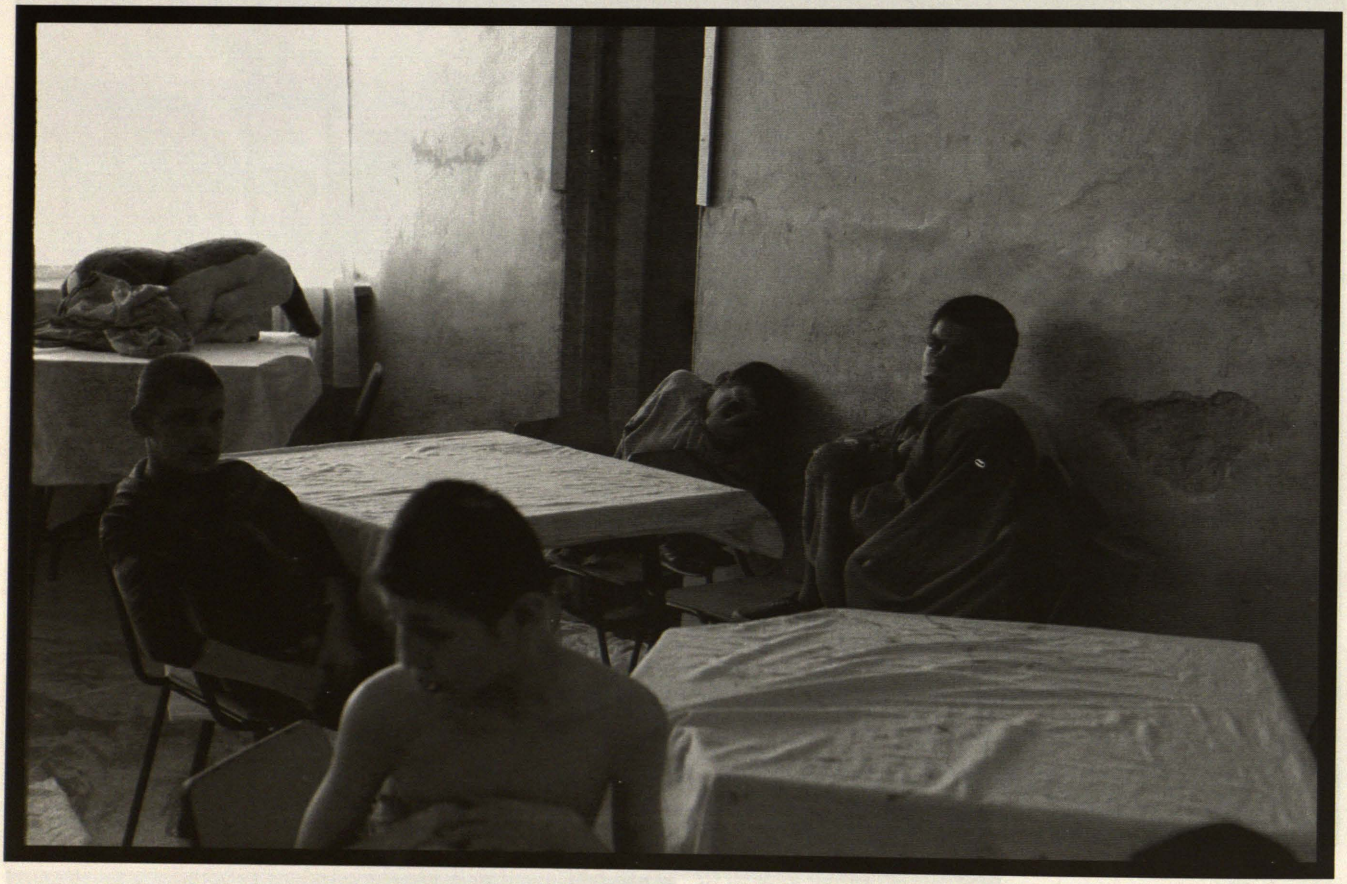


**Above:** This young man is pointing to the blank section of his identity card where his parents' names should be listed. There is a painful stigma attached to orphans in Romania, and whenever potential employers saw this man's identity card, they refused employment outright.

**Right:** The boy on the left spends hours staring desperately out the window, the only light source in the room. His shoelaces have been removed to prevent suicide attempts. The child on the right has retreated from the world entirely, shrouding himself in his tattered sweater.

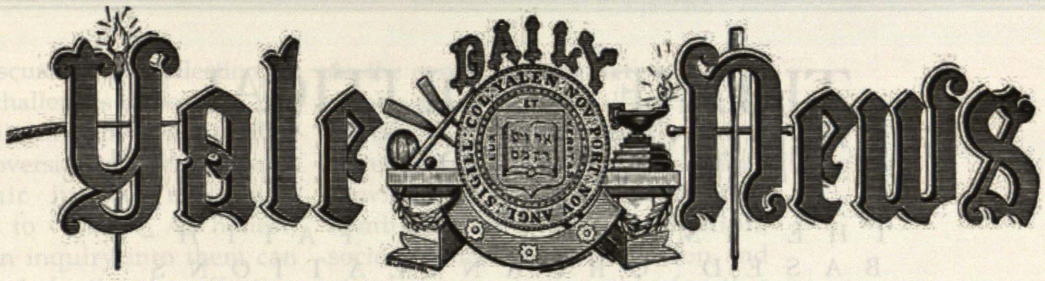
**Below:** This baby is in one of the better orphanages. Cribs are clean, the children are healthy, and the toys are plentiful.





**Above:** There is no form of mental stimulation for the children, forcing them to spend their lives sitting and staring, unmoving and uncaring.

**Right:** The extraordinary filth of the orphanages results in many of the children being afflicted with painful and debilitating bacterial-driven diseases.

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# THE NEW POLITICAL MISSION

## THE IMPACT OF FAITH-BASED ORGANIZATIONS

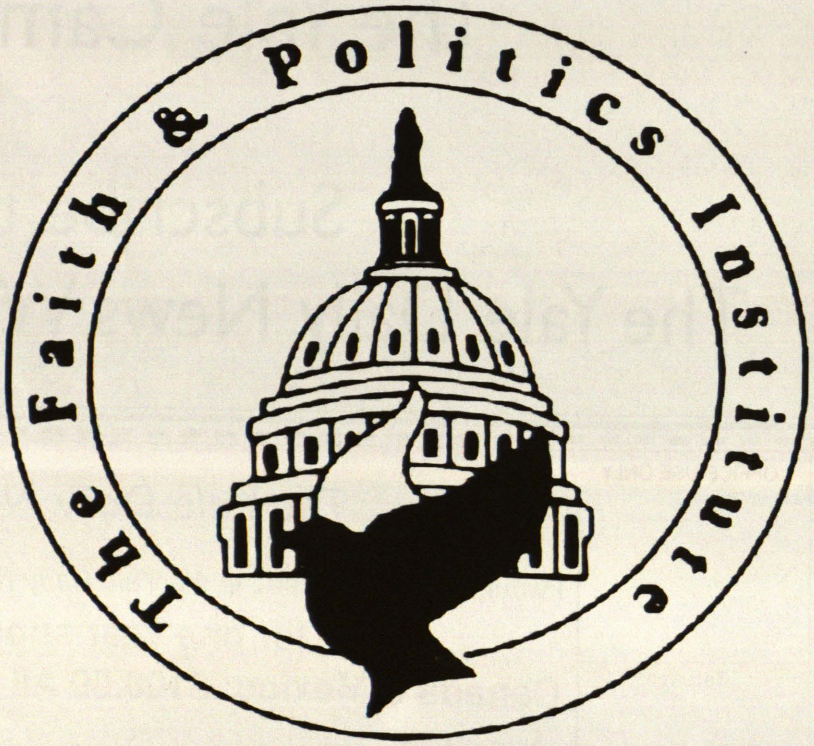
*By Barbara Yu*

*"It is true, political problems are not solved by love and mercy. But the world of politics is not the only world, and unless political decisions rest on a foundation of something better and higher than politics, they can never do any real good for men... There must be a new force, the power of love, the power of understanding and human compassion, the strength of selflessness and cooperation, and the creative dynamism of the will to live and to build and the will to forgive. The will for reconciliation."*

—Thomas Merton

The banality of black business suits hints at something much more significant and true of the Washington community. The subway trains fill every morning with commuters who hide behind newspapers and absorb themselves in paperback novels before emerging from the underground and joining the hordes of other urban professionals walking purposefully towards some desk, in some office, in some building, in the labyrinth that is our nation's capital.

The external appearance of the dark-suited Washington professional does not speak of the work that he or she produces daily, but instead often shrouds the humanity of the person underneath. For these individuals, the weight of the nation's conflicts rests on two levels: atmosphere and professional challenge. Unfortunately, the perpetual rat-race of the Washington environment does not lend itself to venting grief and frustration, nor does it offer specific opportunities for personal and reflective discourse. The challenge of strengthening our nation's leaders *as* leaders has been neglected.




On the corner of Maryland Ave., in a converted church, is the office of the Faith and Politics Institute (FPI), a non-profit, non-partisan, interfaith organization that attempts to provide a public service for those who have made it their life's mission to serve others. The everyday staff consists of seven full-time employees from varied educational, social, and religious backgrounds, and political affiliations. The Board of Directors is chaired by two Members of Congress - the Hon. John Lewis (D-GA), and the Hon. Amo Houghton (R-NY) - and includes many other congressional members and political sympathizers.

"Fostering community and conscience in public life" is at the heart of the FPI's mission. Weekly "Reflection Groups" are often held in a congressional member's office, providing a forum for discourse on the daily travails of public service as well as the current events in each other's lives. The atmosphere is always relaxed, the discussion simple and reflective. Behind closed doors, the dialogue flows without inhibition or concern for the political implications any voiced statements might carry.

In addition to these discussion groups, district dialogues, organized forums, and congressional pilgrimages fill regular portions of the FPI's agenda. The focus of each activity is geared to address political history and

engender discussion and reflection on what these challenges represent.

The FPI is currently concentrating on the controversial and divisive issues of economic justice, race, and alternatives to violence. An honest, non-partisan inquiry into them can provide much footing for effective communication.

Technological and economic progress has experienced an unprecedented boom in the last decade, yet the benefits have hardly been shared by all. The logistics of formalizing and harmonizing relations between labor and management requires the utmost finesse and understanding since the goals of each are so polarized that reaching middle ground often appears impossible, and negotiation seems futile. The rift of malignant feelings thus continues to further push our nation's people apart as our capitalist economy rewards those who strive and achieve. Let us remind ourselves that the right to work is fundamentally still the right to live—and the bottom line of corporate profit should not be the only consideration.

Racial issues divide the country in a multitude of outwardly clear-cut and inwardly overlapping ways. Reconciling these differences is a concern of nearly every elected official. Most of American society has advanced considerably from the days of Jim Crow laws, but much of the mentality that existed hundreds of years ago still lingers. Traces of racism and disharmony continue to pervade society in subtle ways, occasionally manifesting themselves in hate crimes. The nation as a whole would like to believe that these are isolated incidents, attributable to society's few rotten apples and unrepresentative of the general attitude of America. The attrition of such reported cases indicates our continuing humanitarian progress, but our gains are not so flawless that we are at liberty to overlook the necessity of actively and perpetually maintaining equality, promoting compassion, and working towards reconciliation.

The faces and colors of this nation carry with them implicit stereotypes that govern all of us from time to time. As the evolution of society brings us closer together and globalization becomes more personal, these stereotypes become harder to define. Previously unseen and proliferating combinations of education, socioeconomic status, profession, and ethnicity are responsible for this occurrence. The initiative to recognize the blurring of borders and generalizations is the first step in achieving greater harmony with each other, and consequently, internal peace as members of this global community.

Where there is anger, misunderstanding, ignorance, and hatred, violence erupts. Violence destroys, and violence kills. But violence is also reconcilable. Working towards peaceful conflict resolutions decreases the infliction of brutality and limits the number of lives that are lost.

Above all, enlightened citizens should seek to facilitate conversation among our brothers and sisters to determine what compromises can be made, and what misunderstandings should be dealt with. While human beings have natural disagreements, these differences can be minimized if open minds and open hearts willingly come together. As rational beings and as individual moral agents, we all have a responsibility to uphold the tranquility and cohesion of our collective society.

Spiritual reflection and political strategy on these and other issues present an invaluable step toward bringing the nation closer together. Scattered efforts, however, will remain futile unless an enlightened leadership steps forward. To reinforce these ideals in our leaders, it is necessary to provide outlets for civil discourse, to stoke the fires of humanitarian zeal, and to remind our politicians that society can benefit greatly from the casting off of the banal black business suit and the donning of the familial spirit.

*Barbara Yu is a sophomore in Silliman College at Yale. She worked as an intern for the Faith and Politics Institute in Washington, D.C. in the summer of 2001.*

**"Spiritual reflection and political strategy present an invaluable step toward bringing the nation closer together. Scattered efforts, however, will remain futile unless an enlightened leadership steps forward."**

# DEMOCRATIZING YALE

## WHY YALE UNDERGRADS SHOULD SUPPORT GESO

*By Michael Mullins*

Most graduate students don't come to Yale looking to build a union. We come to do laboratory research on life-saving medicines; to analyze comparative politics; to theorize the world's literary traditions; to interpret, in my case, twentieth century American history. Yet, as we spend our years in New Haven, more and more graduate students from across the university are reaching the conclusion that a union is essential to our careers at Yale and beyond.

From the perspective of the broader academy, our movement comes as no surprise. For the last three decades, but especially in recent years, graduate student unions have emerged to address a comprehensive trend in higher education: more and more teaching and research at universities are being performed by academics in part-time, impermanent, and adjunct positions. The ever-increasing ranks of graduate students, visiting scholars, and postdocs in every discipline have responded to this process of "casualization" by organizing around their common interests. In part, this organizing reflects alarm over the growing scarcity of the stable, secure academic careers that we all hope to realize; in part, it reflects our awareness of the profound impact on university life—on the quality of teaching, on academic freedom, on diversity, on research agendas—that accompanies a more insecure, impermanent, and disempowered academic workforce.

At the same time, union bargaining has moved to the mainstream both on the ground and in the courts. The entire University of California system achieved its first contract two years ago; and now 50,000 graduate teachers are working with union contracts on 62 campuses. Closer to home, graduate students at NYU set a national benchmark by winning the right to unionize before the National Labor Relations Board. In the wake of this binding precedent, majorities of graduate students have declared for unions at Columbia and Brown, with Penn and several other universities close on their heels.

But why should Yale undergrads support GESO? Because the interests of grad students and undergrads fundamentally coincide. In the broadest terms, no one benefits from the casualization of academics. As graduate teachers lament the evaporation of permanent faculty jobs, undergrads are finding it harder to count on meeting time, letters of recommendation, or basic academic guidance from established faculty with a long-term position at the institution. But it doesn't stop there.

When we organize for smaller section sizes, teacher training, and better incentives for writing intensive courses, we are improving the quality of classroom teaching at Yale.

When we call for better health benefits and stipends to match the cost of living, we are seeking to ensure that TAs need not be distracted with a second job, or endless research grants, as they seek to conduct their classes.

When we organize to protect the intellectual property rights of researchers, we help to ensure that science at our university serves the public interest and holds to ethical standards—especially at a time when universities are moving headlong into corporate licensing agreements.

And when we fight for diversity of all kinds—for a campus truly accessible to parents, people of color, women, international students, people with debt burdens—we create a more open and representative community of learning.

With its $10.8 billion endowment, Yale's administration certainly can do all of this, and more, to become a model for teaching and research around the world. The Yale community embraces a wide array of talented leaders from all disciplines and walks of life, but the fact remains that an enormous amount of decision-making power remains concentrated with the Yale Corporation and the upper-level administrators directly accountable to it. The majority of those Corporation members come from the world of for-profit business, and the University has been increasingly bearing that stamp: cutting staffing, allowing scientific and educational priorities to follow the market, and regularly seeking to bust unions.

Our premise is straightforward: we believe that the best decisions for a university will be made when the people who work, teach, and study here have meaningful influence over the direction of their institution. The history of unions at Yale shows that only when groups organize themselves do they gain this kind of influence.

We have all worked very hard to get to Yale, and our purpose in GESO is to make good on the high expectations that brought us here. We want to help make Yale into the best possible institution for teaching and research and the community around us. We've been told for too long: if you truly love learning, you'll keep your heads down and move on through. Unionizing graduate students are saying: precisely because we love the university, we must organize ourselves to ensure that we can thrive in our professions, now and in the future.

*Michael Mullins is an organizer for GESO and a third–year PhD student in Yale's Department of History. His research focuses on 20th century American social and political history.*

# GESO UNCOVERED

## DISPELLING THE MYTHS ABOUT GRADUATE STUDENT UNIONS

*By Colleen Shogan*

It is almost impossible to turn our attention away from the terrorism of September 11 to the insular controversies of the Yale campus. However, the important issue of graduate student unionization still remains and in this brief sketch, I will provide four succinct reasons for doubting the validity of graduate student unionization and GESO.

First, despite ten long years of organizing on Yale's campus, GESO does not maintain widespread support amongst graduate students. According to data provided by GESO to the United States Department of Labor, only 750 Yale graduate students are members of GESO. Yale's online Factsheet reports that the official 2000 enrollment of the Graduate School was 2242 students. Therefore, just one-third of Yale graduate students consider themselves as supportive members of the unionization movement on campus. Because GESO makes a lot of noise, it often seems like they represent the majority of Yale graduate students, but this misconception simply isn't true. Rather, the vast majority of GESO's financial support originates not from graduate students who support the cause, but the Hotel Employees and Restaurant Employees International Union (HERE). In the past three years, HERE contributed $303,394.87 to GESO's organizing efforts, while Yale students contributed $715.

Secondly, GESO refuses to answer tough questions in a public forum. In the spring of 2001, the Graduate Student Assembly invited anti-unionization graduate students and GESO to participate in a town meeting. Anti-unionization students agreed immediately to the debate, but GESO pulled its participants at the last minute, effectively running away from the difficult issues that divide both groups. How much will students have to contribute as union dues? Are research assistants included along with teaching assistants in the bargaining unit? What benefits will graduate students have to give up in the collective bargaining process? If GESO leaders can't answer these questions publicly, it is unlikely they possess the resoluteness to represent graduate students at the bargaining table when the chips are down.

**"Suddenly, your adviser is no longer your mentor—he or she is now your adversary."**

Thirdly, GESO contends that unionization will solve the woes of graduate students. However, grad students at other schools who already have unions don't necessarily enjoy better benefits than the current conditions at Yale. For example, at the University of Florida, unionized graduate students have no health care. At Wisconsin, graduate students partially pay for their individual health coverage. At other universities, health care is only provided for students who serve as teaching assistants. Although graduate student unions often profess to "stay out" of disputes within departments, the union at the University of Iowa has repeatedly involved itself in academic disputes. Graduate students at Berkeley went seven years without a contract. During this time period, Berkeley students saw no increases in their stipends. Contrast the Berkeley precedent to Yale, an institution that has steadily elevated teaching fellow pay and dissertation fellowships.

Finally, if labor negotiations do not result in a contract, unionized graduate students might be expected to strike. Imagine if you are currently serving as a teaching fellow for your adviser and you are ordered to stop all teaching-related activities. Suddenly, your adviser is no longer your mentor—he or she is now your adversary. Since the non-sanctioned 1995 grade strike at Yale happened six years ago, GESO pretends that the potential for a strike is minimal. Yet there have been numerous graduate union strikes at Wisconsin-Madison, the University of California, and the University of Michigan in recent years. At the University of Toronto, a TA union strike in 2000 resulted in the cancellation of many undergraduate classes. Furthermore, when other local unions negotiate contracts with Yale, graduate students could be used as bargaining chips or required to engage in "sympathy strikes" to demonstrate solidarity. Most grad students came to Yale to spend their time in the library or at the lab—not on picket lines.

I would like to offer one concluding thought. In recent months, we have witnessed the wrath of injustice that exists in today's world. The plight of Ivy League graduate students clamoring for a labor union seems almost too trivial in comparison to warrant further discussion. Because of recent events, our perspectives have changed dramatically—let us now turn our attention towards issues of justice that transcend these self-absorbed concerns.

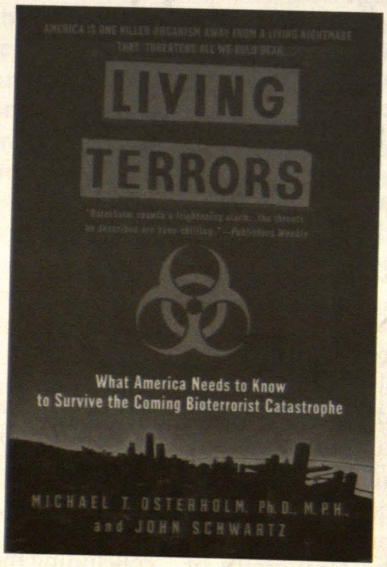
*Colleen Shogan is a fifth–year PhD student in Yale's Department of Political Science.*

# TERRORS OF THE TIMES

## BOOK REVIEW

*By Melissa Blakeley*

Had this book been published a few months earlier than it had, any book review would herald it as "far-fetched" or "overdramatized." However, with its year 2000 copyright and an October 2001 publishing date, this book's arrival coincides with the heightened fear of bioterrorism that the recent cases of anthrax have brought to America. With its informative facade, *Living Terrors* lures the intellectual into the spiral of questions without offering tangible answers as to how to deal with the issue of bioterrorism. *Living Terrors*, by Michael T. Osterholm and John Schwartz, tenaciously frightens its reader with this newly realized threat.




The worst-case bioterrorist scenarios are indeed horrifying. Bioterrorism can strike anyone, anywhere, anytime, without notice; powerful microbes are relatively inexpensive, easy to transmit, and can persist for unspecified periods of time. The authors make and illustrate these points with hypothetical accounts that could affect one's next-door neighbor: a cook dumps billions of *E. coli* into a batch of icing that will be eaten by countless Catholic school children, smallpox permeates the air of a shopping mall at Christmas, and anthrax is dusted upon the crowd at a football game. Although this tactic is arguably extreme, it is effective in presentation. Osterholm and Schwartz seem to exploit the reader's sentimentalities to reinforce the scale of bioterrorism's threat, by incorporating these hypotheticals between chapters of background, methods, facts, types and leading terrorist threats. The interplay of these methods is effective in transmitting information while giving it personal importance. Osterholm and Schwartz are successful in publicizing the details of a possible bioterrorist catastrophe with a sense of immediacy and universality.

However, this book unfortunately presents a problem without a solution. Osterholm himself, an expert on bioterrorism and advisor to the American government, hopes that the book will help people prepare for the possibility of biological catastrophe, while admitting that trying to prepare to combat this silent, deadly threat is effectively impossible.

Furthermore, as this book is written in simple language, its potential audience is vast, which is appropriate since its message should not be limited to anyone. Due to the subject matter, the reader feels helpless upon finishing the book, and, as the authors imply, these emotions are appropriate. Nonetheless, everyone should—and can—read this book.

Reviewed:
*Living Terrors: What America Needs to Know to Survive the Coming Bio-Terror Catastrophe*
By Michael T. Olsterholm and John Schwartz
Delacorte Press, 2000
256 pages. $24.95

Overall, *Living Terror*'s value lies in the questions it proposes; one is forced to rethink the American counter-terrorist strategy, while valuing current liberties. Is America prepared for such a threat? Can doctors even diagnose these deadly diseases, and are medications and vaccinations available on a large enough scale to combat such an attack? How can we prepare to secure both our health and freedoms? Although America is the military superpower of the world, our current weapons simply cannot protect us from microbes.

Osterholm and Schwartz warn the reader of America's complacency by evoking a sense of panic and a call for caution. This is appropriate for both the subject matter and the authors' purpose. *Living Terrors* is informative, gripping, and shockingly real; clearly, it is an effective presentation of bioterrorism. The authors educate the reader about living terrors, while concurrently challenging the reader to fear what is now possible.

*Melissa Blakely is a junior in Morse College at Yale.*

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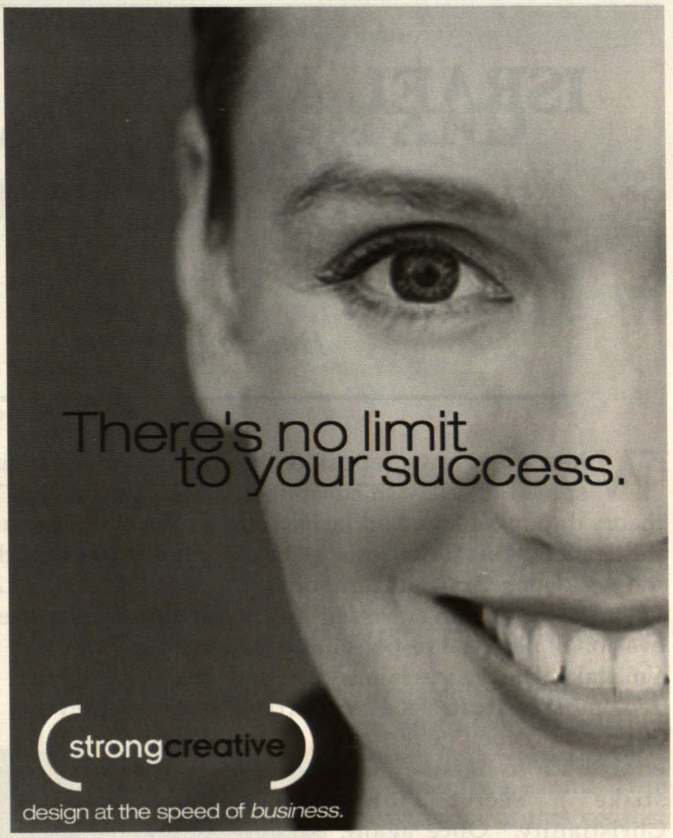


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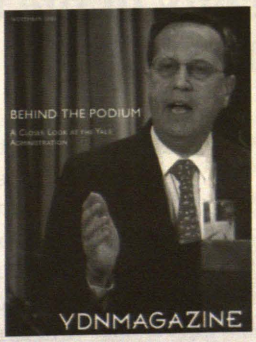


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# ISRAEL AND THE ARAB SCHISM

## THE MIDDLE EAST AT A CROSSROADS

*By Sam Yebri*

When Fox News reported the spread of a Jewish conspiracy theory throughout the Middle East on the day following the terrorist attacks, the world looked on with disapproval, like a parent scolding a young child's evasion of personal responsibility for a mistake. The theory claimed that the September 11th attacks were "carried out by the Israeli government, in an effort both to defame Islam and to strike a secret blow against Christianity." Once again, Islamic fundamentalists have sought to exploit Anti-Semitic sentiment for their own political ends.

For fifty-three years, Islamic militants have actively sought to eliminate the State of Israel from the Middle East. And, for fifty-three years, Israel has successfully protected its right to exist, knowing that the cost of losing a war is simply the end of the Israeli nation. In Israel, no one can forget, or will ever be permitted to forget, the tragic history of the Holocaust and the redemptive establishment of a Jewish homeland. Over the course of the last fifty-three years, Israel has become one of the Middle East's most democratic and westernized nations, while many of its Arab neighbors have struggled with poverty and religious despotism.

It is from within this environment that certain leaders, who, having witnessed the success of armed guerilla-warfare in places such as Vietnam and Algeria, have used terror in their fight for Palestinian independence and international credibility. Three decades later, Israel has yet to submit to terror, but what terror has successfully achieved is to deceive the world's impressions of what is going on in Gaza and Jericho and Hebron.

This international campaign culminated in a highly controversial UN resolution equating Zionism, a nationalist commitment to Israel's mere right to exist, with racism. Any realist will accept the inevitability of a Palestinian state; the question is no longer if, but when and under what circumstances Palestine will be established. However, cooperation and negotiation have proven unsuccessful with the leadership of the Palestinian Authority. Former Prime Minister Ehud Barak's proposal of "unilateral separation" is the only pragmatic answer to an Arab world committed to the principle of *jihad*.

**"The Arab world is still struggling...with the division between radical fundamentalists and a new generation of Arab and Muslim leaders sympathetic to modernization and the improvement in the quality of life that it will bring."**

In fact, it is the contradiction embodied by this very word that is most telling. According to the Koran, *jihad* does not mean "a holy war," but rather, a spiritual conflict, a concerted effort to live a moral life. The Koran condemns all violence excluding that of self-defense; yet, fundamentalist groups in the Middle East have used this principle as a moral excuse and political tool to galvanize support and resist the forces of progress and modernization that globalization have produced. A militant minority has championed the cause of a radical revolution, once again using Anti-Semitic sentiment and the notion of a Zionist conspiracy as its justification.

Sadeq al-Azm, an American-educated Syrian intellectual, noted in 1968 that Arabs "have made room in [their] rooms for the refrigerator, the television set, oil wells, MIG airplanes, but the mentality that uses these imported products remains the same traditional mentality that belongs to bedouin, agrarian supernatural stages that preceded the industrial revolution". Three decades later, the Arab world is still struggling with the post-colonial reality of the 21st century: the division between radical fundamentalists and a new generation of Arab and Muslim leaders sympathetic to modernization and the improvement in the quality of life that it will bring. It is this schism in the Arab world that the United States must seek to exploit. Simply look at past inter-regional clashes as evidence of the conflicts and interests that have transcended Arab unity, between Iran and Iraq, Pakistan and Bangladesh, and of course Iraq's invasion of Kuwait. Nations like Egypt and Jordan should serve as models of nations making the difficult decisions in regard to its relationship with Israel, its own interpretation of Islamic law and its attitude towards globalization. The challenge to the Arab world today is to embrace modernism as a means to improve the Middle East's quality of life and reject radical traditionalism.

*Sam Yebri is a junior in Ezra Stiles College at Yale. He is President of Yale Friends of Israel.*

# NEW AMERICAN NATIONALISM AND OLD–WORLD ETHNIC CONFLICT

REFLECTION

*By J. Benjamin Schrader*

There is an old formula that the leaders of small rebellious nations have traditionally used in fostering support for their particular causes. Its central method is provocation, specifically the provocation of larger powers perceived as belligerent in one way or another to smaller powers. The attack on the Pentagon and the World Trade Center on September 11, engineered by the cunning and committed aides of Osama bin Laden, demonstrated the effectiveness of instigation in uniting a group toward a particular goal. In this case, Al Qaeda successfully provoked a serious military response from the United States and from other Western powers. This retaliation effort, justified as it is, provides bin Laden with the perfect propagandistic ammunition to rally the sentiments of the Muslim world against the threat of a belligerent West who, as bin Ladin argued, merely deserved what it received on September 11.

An important key to bin Laden's ploy is revealed in a strange twist to this new war: the retaliatory powers actually seek to *prevent* Afghan casualties, claiming that their war is with the Taliban and not with the people of Afghanistan. Bin Laden, conversely, covertly encourages a significant loss of life among Afghanistan's residents to better make his case for jihad against the infidels of the West. This is one of the few wars in which the figure of the attacked eagerly condones the slaughter of his own people, while the attackers themselves make every effort to prevent the loss of enemy civilian life.

What the United States must avoid is the successful formation of a unified Muslim front with extremists at its fore, and the polarization of this conflict along ethnic lines. Bin Laden is preaching the familiar strains of ethnic nationalism, which promotes the construction of states according to religious and ethnic criteria. His beliefs signal an ideological return to the numerous incidents of ethnic cleansing during the decay of the Ottoman Empire. The example of Turkey, in fact, will provide a striking model for today's Afghan conflict.

In 1921, Eleutherios Venizelos' Greek forces invaded Smyrna in a powerful manifestation of the popular "Megali Idea," the vision of a return to Hellenism across a vast landscape owned and operated by the Greeks themselves. During their occupation, the Greeks treated the resident Turks harshly, looting the land and defiling Turkish women. Mustafa Kemal, a Turkish nationalist who sought to affirm his power, mobilized the will of the Turkish population against the invading Greeks. Kemal was able to foster effectively the idea of a Turkish

nation, of a "Turkey for the Turks," successfully deposing the Ottoman sultanate and formally establishing a ruling party in 1923 based on notions of religious and ethnic purity in the state of Turkey.

This historical example is predicated upon several antiquated notions of statebuilding, and parallels the current situation in Afghanistan in two different ways. Kemal's ideas depended most firmly on the assumption that the best state is an ethnically homogeneous one, free from religious, political and cultural "impurities" that might hinder its development as a unified nation. Granted, the need for political stability at the time allowed for some ethnic concessions, but the fundamental difference in this concept of statemaking and that of the United States is perfectly clear: the Turks perceived diversity of religion, politics, and culture as a weakness, as a threat to the effective and stable formation of the state, that would ultimately undermine the legitimacy of state institutions.

**"Ethnic homogeneity necessarily leads to political homogeneity, which in turn assures the promulgation of only one set of ideas for state governance. In this way, sameness serves as the fatal flaw for states like Turkey and Afghanistan."**

The drawbacks to this line of thinking are numerous, and they have been hammered into us since elementary school. Ethnic homogeneity necessarily leads to political homogeneity, which in turn assures the promulgation of only one set of ideas for state governance. In this way, sameness serves as the fatal flaw for states like Turkey and Afghanistan: the lack of a free market of ideas in a state subjugates that state to all others that foster a meritocracy of ideas, and eventually fails to allow the state to legitimately compete on an international level in virtually every way.

State-sanctioned ethnic segregation chisels away the integrity of the state on two levels: it facilitates the psychological ruin of those who are identified for rejection from the state (an action which becomes tantamount to forced removal from one's own home and heritage), and hardens ethnic stereotypes by lending the authority of the state to the confirmation of a class structure based on ethnicity. Additionally, state-sponsored selection and expulsion of a particular ethnic group propagate themselves on a lack of information, highlighting and embellishing only the characteristics of the targeted group that the state envisions as negative. This, in turn, blinds the general public to a full understanding of ostracized peoples, and affirms the beliefs fostered by the state.

The parallel between the Turkish-Greek conflict and that of the Taliban and the Americans develops differently before and after the events of September 11. In both cases, bin Laden is the Kemal figure, employing an American "invasion" to garner additional Muslim support for his cause. But this American incursion is different before and after the 11th, as perceived by bin Laden and associates. The United States is now confirming with weapons what it had before been practicing with economics and culture: the worldwide dissemination of its capitalist imperialism in an effort to coordinate the creation of a vast American hegemony ruled in tandem by Jesus and Ronald McDonald. American bombs in Afghanistan are a clear demonstration of what bin Laden had been claiming all along: that the Americans will stop at nothing to control everything they can get their democratic claws on.

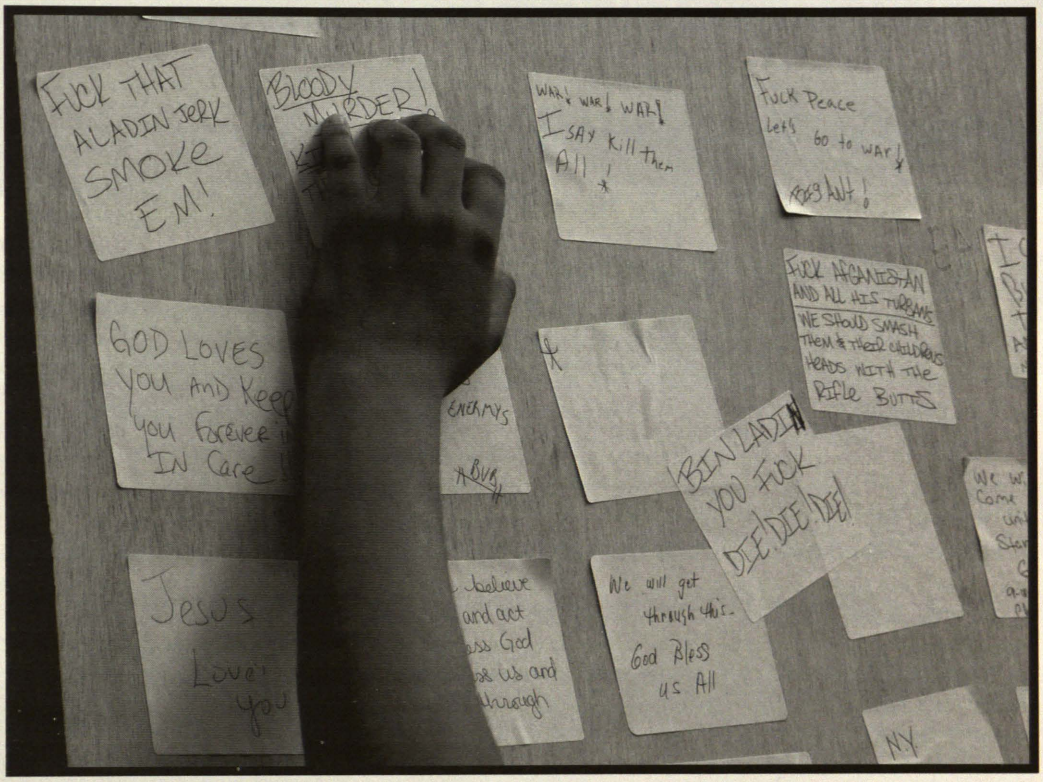
The American response to the penetration of its borders has differed markedly from the Afghan reaction. Unsure of who exactly should be held accountable for the attack on America, Americans find it difficult to concentrate hatred effectively on one particular state or figure (except, of course, for the Taliban and bin Laden, who merely mastermind one extensive terrorist network out of many). Fearing another nontraditional assault, Americans are feverishly contemplating the various ways in which they might protect themselves from the attack of a faceless enemy. Through all of this confusion and general uncertainty, the unity of the American response is significant in one very important way which distinguishes its new nationalism from that of the old world: the achievement of consonance despite the overwhelming diversity of the American people.

The American response to the attacks of September 11 is a devastating rebuke to the proponents of ethnic nationalism. The fear of ethnic

nationalists that cultural, social and political diversity, accompanied by American freedoms, will ultimately result in the instability and decay of the state has been quickly and clearly dismissed. The attacks against the American way of life served to mobilize a nation defined by its differences, and worked counter to bin Laden's hope for American domestic dissonance.

This is not to suggest that some Americans have not dissented. Certainly there have been anti-war protests, some of them on the Yale campus. But there is no reason to discourage this protest: it is not merely the right, but the duty of Americans to speak out against what they believe to be wrong, and it is a validation of democracy that tolerated dissonance comprises a portion of the American response to war.

A final distinguishing factor between America's new nationalism and that which the Taliban wishes to stoke among the Afghan people is the distinct nature of the targets that each has identified as the enemy. The United States has declared that it will seek to eliminate all elements of terrorism, that it will destroy all purveyors of the notion that it is just to attack innocent civilians with the intention of coercing societies or government. The Taliban, conversely, has made it clear that it intends to do just that: harass or kill the citizens of foreign nations in order to convince the government of those citizens to do its will. In this case, the Taliban has one particular target: the American citizen, as a representative of the American way of life. This identifier, in itself, is ethnic, although it is more political than religious or ideological. The Taliban's primary objective is to demonstrate that this war is in fact between the Muslim world and the rest of the international community, a jihad like none before it, at its core a deep ethnic conflict.




But here is America's answer: the United States will gladly fight on ideological grounds, but will firmly reject the notion that the present conflict is based along ethnic lines. The American fight is against ideas, not people, and this notion is what separates it from the Afghan movement. There is no doubt that Muslims and Muslim-Americans in the future will not be viewed by other Americans as they have been in the past – the photograph on this page asserts as much, and that is a serious black mark for modern American tolerance. But that does not discount the refusal of the American government to divide this conflict along ethnic lines. In the new American nationalism, ideas that kill innocent people are expelled, along with the people who promote them. The United States will not allow bin Laden to succeed in framing this conflict along ethnic lines – if it does, the jihad *will* become real, the very American ideals that bin Laden blasphemed on September 11 will be sacrificed, and he will win, no matter how the bodies ultimately fall.

*Ben Schrader is a junior in Pierson College at Yale University.*

**"There is no reason to discourage protest: it is not merely the right, but the duty of Americans to speak out against what they believe to be wrong, and it is a validation of democracy that tolerated dissonance comprises a portion of the American response to war."**

# THE SEARCH FOR ANSWERS

## A GENERATION'S ATTEMPT TO UNDERSTAND THE UNIMAGINABLE

*By Brian Wallach*

Having lived through September 11, 2001; having sat in front of a television in my friend's dorm room alternately staring at the screen in disbelief and frantically trying to reach my parents who live and work in Washington D.C.; having had hundreds of conversations with my friends about the events of September 11th, I am still not sure that I could explain the feelings of that day to someone who was not alive to experience it. In a twenty-four hour period, the innocence and sense of security that I had grown accustomed to for the first twenty years of my life was violently shattered. As I looked around at the faces of my friends that day, I could tell that no other event in our lives provided a point of reference from which we could begin to understand what we had just witnessed. Much as the generation who fought in World War I, the first total war the world had ever experienced, struggled to make sense of a war that defied traditional explanations, my generation spent the days after September 11th searching for a way to understand how and why something like this could happen.

Until September 11th, my generation, those young men and women who are in their early twenties, had been fortunate enough to grow up in an era when the United States seemed to be protected from the problems of war, of terrorism, and of uncertainty that were endemic in the rest of the world. We did not know of the paranoia of the Cold War and could not ever really understand what it was like to live through two world wars that claimed over sixty million lives. Instead, we grew up with the Internet, became teenage millionaires, and reached maturity in a previously unparalleled time of prosperity and opportunity. We read about the problems of the world and at times witnessed their direct impact upon the United States, but nothing we had experienced in our lives could provide us with the explanations that we so desperately needed to understand an act of terror such as this.

On the night of the attacks, the undergraduate and graduate population of Yale University gathered together in the center of its campus for a candlelight vigil. As I stood among my fellow students I searched the faces of those around me. Some cried, some stared stoically off into the night, and others looked back at me with a shared sense of confusion and fear. We were all looking for someone who would have the magic phrase which when heard would assure us that everything would be all right. By the time former President Bill Clinton spoke three weeks later in the same area where the students had gathered for the candlelight vigil and told the students that everything would be all right, we had somehow already figured that out.

In the hundreds of faces that gathered together at the candlelight vigil, I saw finally what it meant to be an American. There were faces of all different colors, different sexes, different political attitudes, and different backgrounds, but one unifying trait: we are a generation bound together by our common belief in the ideas for which America stands. We may not believe in the same gods, we may not have the same views on abortion or gun control, but for the first time the young men and women of my generation found in themselves a sense of self, of patriotism, and of unity, which we had never previously known. As these ideas replaced the innocence of youth, I finally realized that maybe everything would be all right.

The next morning I saw American flags appear all over campus and I received numerous emails from my friends telling me they were all right or asking if everyone I knew was OK. As I witnessed these changes, I realized that I may never know how or why someone could perform an act of terrorism such as that perpetrated on September 11th, but I found an idea strong enough to convince myself that tomorrow the sun would still shine. When I woke up on September 12th, I looked out the window at the American flag flying from the front of my house. I finally understood that the ideals which that flag symbolizes had not been changed by the terrorist attacks and that as long as that flag flew everything would be all right.

*Brian Wallach is a junior in Timothy Dwight College at Yale.*

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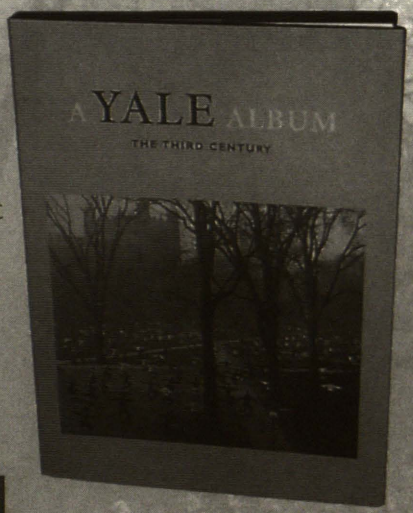

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